64 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Environment & Energy

Từ và cụm quan trọng được tô màu; cuối mỗi bài là các cụm cần nhớ kèm nghĩa. Điểm do AI chấm, chỉ để tham khảo.

Cụm từ | Từ đồng nghĩa | Từ nối | Khung câu | Câu mang ý | Câu ví dụ

Discuss both views

#2 Discuss both views · 280 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 8.0)

Some people believe that protecting the environment should be a top priority for governments. Others think that economic growth is more important. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether protecting the environment should be a top priority for governments or whether economic growth matters more. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, those who put economic growth first argue that strict environmental measures can raise costs for businesses and slow short-term growth. Factories must install cleaner equipment, and firms may respond by raising prices or cutting jobs. This matters most in poorer countries, where growth is needed to lift people out of poverty and to pay for hospitals and schools. A developing country that bans cheap coal before it has an alternative, for example, may leave millions of households without affordable electricity, and the resulting hardship can turn public opinion against environmental policy. Higher bills for fuel and food are felt immediately, whereas the benefits of cleaner air arrive slowly, so voters often resist change.

On the other hand, supporters of environmental protection point out that ignoring the environment is expensive in the long run. Floods, droughts and polluted air damage crops, homes and health, and the cost of cleaning up afterwards is usually far higher than the cost of preventing the damage. Environmental policy can also create growth, since renewable energy, insulation and recycling employ workers and encourage new technology. A city that invests in clean transport, for instance, reduces hospital costs from air pollution while creating jobs in construction and maintenance.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that environmental protection should take priority in the long term, because growth built on damage cannot last, although governments should introduce measures gradually so that businesses and poorer households have time to adapt.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a top priority for governments** — ưu tiên hàng đầu của chính phủ
- **put economic growth first** — đặt tăng trưởng kinh tế lên đầu
- **strict environmental measures** — biện pháp môi trường nghiêm ngặt
- **raise costs for businesses** — làm tăng chi phí doanh nghiệp
- **slow short-term growth** — làm chậm tăng trưởng ngắn hạn
- **install cleaner equipment** — lắp thiết bị sạch hơn
- **raising prices or cutting jobs** — tăng giá hoặc cắt việc làm
- **lift people out of poverty** — giúp người dân thoát nghèo
- **bans cheap coal** — cấm than giá rẻ
- **affordable electricity** — điện giá phải chăng
- **turn public opinion against** — làm dư luận quay lưng với
- **supporters of environmental protection** — người ủng hộ bảo vệ môi trường
- **ignoring the environment** — phớt lờ môi trường
- **expensive in the long run** — đắt về lâu dài
- **Floods, droughts and polluted air** — lũ, hạn hán và không khí ô nhiễm
- **cleaning up afterwards** — dọn dẹp sau đó
- **far higher than the cost of preventing the damage** — cao hơn nhiều so với chi phí ngăn thiệt hại
- **encourage new technology** — khuyến khích công nghệ mới
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **take priority** — được ưu tiên
- **growth built on damage cannot last** — tăng trưởng dựa trên tàn phá không bền
- **have time to adapt** — có thời gian thích nghi

#3 Discuss both views · 277 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Some people prefer environmentally friendly products while others prefer cheaper alternatives. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether people should buy environmentally friendly products or choose cheaper alternatives. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of green products argue that environmentally friendly products reduce harm and often save money over time. They use less energy, create less waste and are often more durable, and growing demand encourages companies to improve their methods. An efficient light bulb, for example, may cost more at first but lasts much longer and uses far less electricity. Buyers who choose such goods also send a clear signal to manufacturers that the market wants cleaner production. If enough people do this, prices tend to fall and green options become normal.

On the other hand, others point out that many households simply cannot afford to pay extra for green products. When budgets are tight, families have to choose the cheapest option, and for people on low incomes the price on the label matters more than long-term benefits. Some products labelled green make claims that are exaggerated or hard to check, so shoppers may pay more without any real gain for the environment. Cheap alternatives therefore remain popular unless prices fall or rules improve. A parent who is buying clothes and food for a family of five, for instance, cannot always choose the more expensive version. In such cases, affordable green options are far more helpful than moral pressure.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that people should choose green products where they can afford them, while governments should make them cheaper through taxes and clear labelling so that the choice becomes easier for everyone.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **environmentally friendly products** — sản phẩm thân thiện môi trường
- **cheaper alternatives** — lựa chọn rẻ hơn
- **supporters of green products** — người ủng hộ sản phẩm xanh
- **reduce harm** — giảm tác hại
- **save money over time** — tiết kiệm tiền theo thời gian
- **create less waste** — tạo ít rác hơn
- **more durable** — bền hơn
- **growing demand encourages companies** — nhu cầu tăng khuyến khích công ty
- **improve their methods** — cải thiện phương pháp
- **send a clear signal** — gửi tín hiệu rõ ràng
- **cleaner production** — sản xuất sạch hơn
- **prices tend to fall** — giá có xu hướng giảm
- **afford to pay extra** — đủ khả năng trả thêm
- **budgets are tight** — ngân sách eo hẹp
- **the price on the label** — giá ghi trên nhãn
- **long-term benefits** — lợi ích dài hạn
- **exaggerated or hard to check** — bị phóng đại hoặc khó kiểm chứng
- **pay more without any real gain** — trả nhiều hơn mà không có lợi ích thực
- **unless prices fall or rules improve** — trừ khi giá giảm hoặc quy định tốt hơn
- **clear labelling** — ghi nhãn rõ ràng

#10 Discuss both views · 285 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Should individuals be responsible for pollution, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Opinions are divided as to whether individuals should take responsibility for pollution or whether society and governments should act. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, those who stress personal responsibility argue that everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. Millions of households decide how much they drive, how much rubbish they produce and which products they buy, and these habits determine how much pollution is created. Consumers who choose cleaner products also push companies to change, since firms follow demand. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A commuter who swaps a daily car journey for a bicycle, for example, removes a small but real source of exhaust fumes, and many people doing the same would make a noticeable difference to the air in a city.

On the other hand, supporters of government action point out that individuals alone cannot solve problems that are largely structural. A person cannot choose a clean power station or a factory that filters its emissions, and the biggest sources of pollution are often industries rather than households. Governments can set rules that apply to everyone, such as emission limits and fines, which create a level playing field so that responsible firms are not undercut by careless ones. They can also build the public transport and waste systems that make green choices practical. A resident of a town with no reliable buses, for instance, has little choice but to drive.

In conclusion, both sides have a point. Personally, I believe that governments should take the lead because they control the rules and the infrastructure, while individuals play a complementary role by supporting and following them.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **take responsibility for pollution** — chịu trách nhiệm về ô nhiễm
- **stress personal responsibility** — nhấn mạnh trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **how much rubbish they produce** — họ xả bao nhiêu rác
- **push companies to change** — thúc ép doanh nghiệp thay đổi
- **firms follow demand** — doanh nghiệp chạy theo nhu cầu
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **exhaust fumes** — khói thải
- **make a noticeable difference** — tạo khác biệt rõ rệt
- **supporters of government action** — người ủng hộ hành động của chính phủ
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **largely structural** — chủ yếu mang tính hệ thống
- **clean power** — điện sạch
- **filters its emissions** — lọc khí thải
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **emission limits** — giới hạn khí thải
- **create a level playing field** — tạo sân chơi bình đẳng
- **undercut by careless ones** — bị doanh nghiệp cẩu thả cạnh tranh giá
- **waste systems** — hệ thống xử lý rác
- **make green choices practical** — làm lựa chọn xanh khả thi
- **little choice but to drive** — không có lựa chọn nào ngoài lái xe
- **take the lead** — đi đầu
- **control the rules and the infrastructure** — nắm luật lệ và hạ tầng
- **a complementary role** — vai trò bổ trợ

#32 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 8.0)

Should individuals be responsible for conserving water, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Water shortages are becoming more common in many regions, and people disagree about who should be responsible for conserving water. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, some argue that individuals should save water because everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. Households use water for showers, washing machines and gardens, and simple habits such as turning off taps, fixing leaks and collecting rainwater can reduce consumption considerably. Consumers who buy water-efficient appliances also push manufacturers to improve their designs. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A family that repairs a dripping tap and takes shorter showers, for example, may save thousands of litres a year, and if a whole neighbourhood follows, the effect on local supplies becomes significant.

On the other hand, others believe that governments must act because individuals alone cannot solve problems that are largely structural. Much of a city's water is lost through ageing pipes that only the utility can replace, and farming and industry use far more than households. Authorities can set rules that apply to everyone, such as limits during droughts, higher prices for heavy users and fines for waste, and only they can build reservoirs, treatment plants and efficient irrigation. A city that loses a third of its water through old pipes, for instance, wastes more than its residents could ever save.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the most effective approach combines official leadership with personal action, as governments should repair the system while citizens supply the daily decisions that make policies work.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Water shortages** — tình trạng thiếu nước
- **conserving water** — tiết kiệm nước
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **turning off taps** — tắt vòi nước
- **fixing leaks** — sửa chỗ rò rỉ
- **collecting rainwater** — hứng nước mưa
- **reduce consumption considerably** — giảm mức tiêu thụ đáng kể
- **water-efficient appliances** — thiết bị tiết kiệm nước
- **improve their designs** — cải thiện thiết kế
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **a dripping tap** — vòi nước rỉ
- **local supplies** — nguồn cấp địa phương
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **largely structural** — chủ yếu mang tính hệ thống
- **ageing pipes** — đường ống cũ
- **the utility** — công ty cấp nước
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **limits during droughts** — hạn chế trong mùa hạn
- **higher prices for heavy users** — giá cao hơn cho người dùng nhiều
- **fines for waste** — phạt hành vi lãng phí
- **reservoirs, treatment plants** — hồ chứa, nhà máy xử lý
- **efficient irrigation** — tưới tiêu hiệu quả
- **wastes more than its residents could ever save** — lãng phí nhiều hơn cư dân tiết kiệm được
- **official leadership** — sự dẫn dắt của chính quyền
- **personal action** — hành động cá nhân
- **repair the system** — sửa hệ thống
- **daily decisions** — quyết định hằng ngày
- **make policies work** — làm chính sách phát huy tác dụng

#92 Discuss both views · 272 từ · AI 7.5

Should individuals be responsible for reducing their carbon footprint, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Climate change has made many people ask who should be responsible for reducing carbon emissions: individuals or society as a whole. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of personal responsibility argue that everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. Millions of households decide how they travel, how they heat their homes and what they eat, and flying less, eating less meat and using energy-saving appliances can cut a family's carbon footprint significantly. Consumers who choose low-carbon products also push companies to change, since firms follow demand. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A commuter who swaps a daily car journey for a bicycle, for example, avoids a noticeable amount of exhaust gas each year, and the savings multiply when a whole workplace joins in.

On the other hand, advocates of collective action point out that individuals alone cannot solve problems that are largely structural. Most emissions come from power stations, factories and transport systems that people cannot redesign themselves, and a customer cannot choose clean electricity if the grid still burns coal. Governments can set rules that apply to everyone, such as carbon taxes and efficiency standards, and only they can build the public transport and renewable power networks that make green choices practical. A resident of a town with no reliable buses or trains, for instance, has little choice but to drive.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that governments should take the lead, since they control the rules and the infrastructure, while individuals make policies work through their daily decisions.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **reducing carbon emissions** — giảm phát thải carbon
- **society as a whole** — toàn xã hội
- **supporters of personal responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **energy-saving appliances** — thiết bị tiết kiệm điện
- **cut a family's carbon footprint** — giảm dấu chân carbon của một gia đình
- **low-carbon products** — sản phẩm ít carbon
- **push companies to change** — thúc ép doanh nghiệp thay đổi
- **firms follow demand** — doanh nghiệp chạy theo nhu cầu
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **exhaust gas** — khí thải
- **the savings multiply** — lượng tiết kiệm nhân lên
- **advocates of collective action** — người ủng hộ hành động tập thể
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **largely structural** — chủ yếu mang tính hệ thống
- **power stations** — nhà máy điện
- **redesign themselves** — tự thiết kế lại
- **clean electricity** — điện sạch
- **the grid still burns coal** — lưới điện vẫn đốt than
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **carbon taxes** — thuế carbon
- **efficiency standards** — tiêu chuẩn hiệu suất
- **renewable power networks** — mạng lưới điện tái tạo
- **make green choices practical** — làm lựa chọn xanh khả thi
- **little choice but to drive** — không có lựa chọn nào ngoài lái xe
- **take the lead** — đi đầu
- **control the rules and the infrastructure** — nắm luật lệ và hạ tầng
- **make policies work** — làm chính sách phát huy tác dụng
- **daily decisions** — quyết định hằng ngày

#112 Discuss both views · 273 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for protecting wildlife, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

The loss of habitats and species raises the question of who should be responsible for protecting wildlife: ordinary people, or governments and society. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, some argue that individuals have a duty to protect wildlife because everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. People decide whether to buy products made from endangered animals, whether to leave rubbish in natural areas and whether to support conservation charities. Gardeners who plant native flowers and leave small wild corners also give insects and birds a place to live. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A hiker who takes litter home and keeps to marked paths, for example, causes far less disturbance to nesting birds, and if thousands of visitors behave in the same way the damage to a reserve is greatly reduced.

On the other hand, others claim that governments must lead because individuals alone cannot solve problems that are largely structural. The greatest threats to wildlife, such as the clearing of forests, industrial pollution and large-scale illegal hunting, are far beyond the reach of personal action. Governments can set rules that apply to everyone, such as protected reserves and heavy penalties for poaching, and only they can fund the rangers and monitoring that make these rules real. A national park without enough guards, for instance, soon becomes a hunting ground.

In conclusion, both sides are partly right. I believe that governments should take the lead, since they control the law and the funding, while individuals make protection work by following the rules and supporting it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **The loss of habitats and species** — sự mất môi trường sống và loài
- **protecting wildlife** — bảo vệ động vật hoang dã
- **a duty to protect** — nghĩa vụ bảo vệ
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **endangered animals** — động vật nguy cấp
- **conservation charities** — tổ chức từ thiện bảo tồn
- **plant native flowers** — trồng hoa bản địa
- **leave small wild corners** — chừa những góc hoang dã nhỏ
- **a place to live** — nơi sinh sống
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **takes litter home** — mang rác về nhà
- **keeps to marked paths** — đi theo lối đã đánh dấu
- **disturbance to nesting birds** — quấy rầy chim làm tổ
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **largely structural** — chủ yếu mang tính hệ thống
- **the clearing of forests** — việc phá rừng
- **industrial pollution** — ô nhiễm công nghiệp
- **large-scale illegal hunting** — săn bắt trái phép quy mô lớn
- **beyond the reach of personal action** — vượt tầm hành động cá nhân
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **protected reserves** — khu bảo tồn
- **heavy penalties for poaching** — hình phạt nặng cho săn trộm
- **fund the rangers and monitoring** — tài trợ kiểm lâm và giám sát
- **a hunting ground** — bãi săn
- **take the lead** — đi đầu

#152 Discuss both views · 267 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for recycling, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Recycling is widely encouraged, yet people disagree about whether it is mainly a personal duty or something that society and governments should organise. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of individual responsibility argue that everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. Households decide whether to sort glass, paper and plastic or to throw everything into one bin, and careless sorting can spoil whole loads of recyclable material. Shoppers who choose products with less packaging also push companies to reduce waste. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A family that separates its rubbish carefully every week, for example, keeps a large amount of material out of landfill, and a street where everyone does the same can cut its waste dramatically.

On the other hand, advocates of collective action point out that individuals alone cannot recycle what the system cannot process. A household cannot build a sorting plant or create a market for recycled materials, and many people live in areas where collection is irregular or unavailable. Governments can set rules that apply to everyone, such as deposit schemes and requirements for manufacturers to use recycled content, and only they can build the infrastructure that makes recycling practical. A resident with no collection point nearby, for instance, has little chance of recycling even when they want to.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the most effective approach combines official leadership with personal action, since government provides the system and citizens supply the daily effort that makes it work.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a personal duty** — bổn phận cá nhân
- **organise** — tổ chức
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **sort glass, paper and plastic** — phân loại thuỷ tinh, giấy và nhựa
- **throw everything into one bin** — vứt mọi thứ vào một thùng
- **careless sorting** — phân loại cẩu thả
- **spoil whole loads of recyclable material** — làm hỏng cả mẻ vật liệu tái chế
- **products with less packaging** — sản phẩm ít bao bì
- **reduce waste** — giảm rác thải
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **keeps a large amount of material out of landfill** — giữ nhiều vật liệu khỏi bãi chôn lấp
- **cut its waste dramatically** — giảm mạnh lượng rác
- **advocates of collective action** — người ủng hộ hành động tập thể
- **recycle what the system cannot process** — tái chế thứ hệ thống không xử lý được
- **a sorting plant** — nhà máy phân loại
- **a market for recycled materials** — thị trường vật liệu tái chế
- **collection is irregular or unavailable** — thu gom thất thường hoặc không có
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **deposit schemes** — chương trình đặt cọc vỏ chai
- **recycled content** — thành phần tái chế
- **makes recycling practical** — làm tái chế khả thi
- **official leadership** — sự dẫn dắt của chính quyền
- **personal action** — hành động cá nhân
- **provides the system** — cung cấp hệ thống
- **daily effort** — nỗ lực hằng ngày

#185 Discuss both views · 275 từ · AI 7.0

Some people believe that climate change is mainly caused by human activity. Others think natural factors are more significant. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether climate change is mainly caused by human activity or whether natural factors are more significant. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, those who emphasise natural factors point out that the climate has always changed through natural causes. Volcanic eruptions, variations in the sun's energy and shifts in ocean currents produced warm periods and ice ages long before humans existed. Some people therefore argue that today's warming may be part of a natural cycle, and that human influence is exaggerated. This view also reminds us that climate science is complex, and that scientists continue to study natural variation in order to improve their predictions.

On the other hand, supporters of the human-activity explanation argue that scientific evidence links the recent rise in temperatures to human activity. Burning coal, oil and gas and clearing forests release gases that trap heat, and temperatures have risen alongside emissions since the industrial era began. Natural cycles, which operate over thousands of years, cannot explain such rapid warming. A greenhouse works in a similar way, which is why these gases are said to warm the planet. In addition, studies of past climates show that the present rate of change is unusually fast. Taken together, these findings make it difficult to treat natural cycles as the main explanation, and most scientists therefore regard human activity as the principal driver.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that human activity is the main cause, since the speed of the current warming cannot be explained by natural cycles, although natural factors still shape the climate.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **mainly caused by human activity** — chủ yếu do hoạt động con người
- **natural factors** — yếu tố tự nhiên
- **emphasise natural factors** — nhấn mạnh yếu tố tự nhiên
- **Volcanic eruptions** — núi lửa phun trào
- **variations in the sun's energy** — biến thiên năng lượng mặt trời
- **shifts in ocean currents** — thay đổi của dòng hải lưu
- **warm periods and ice ages** — thời kỳ ấm và kỷ băng hà
- **part of a natural cycle** — một phần chu kỳ tự nhiên
- **human influence is exaggerated** — ảnh hưởng của con người bị phóng đại
- **natural variation** — biến thiên tự nhiên
- **improve their predictions** — cải thiện dự báo
- **scientific evidence** — bằng chứng khoa học
- **Burning coal, oil and gas** — đốt than, dầu và khí
- **clearing forests** — phá rừng
- **trap heat** — giữ nhiệt
- **alongside emissions** — song song với khí thải
- **the industrial era** — kỷ nguyên công nghiệp
- **such rapid warming** — sự nóng lên nhanh như vậy
- **warm the planet** — làm nóng hành tinh
- **unusually fast** — nhanh bất thường
- **shape the climate** — định hình khí hậu

#252 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for energy conservation, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

As energy prices and emissions rise, people debate whether individuals should be responsible for saving energy or whether society and governments should take action. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, some argue that households should conserve energy because everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. People decide whether to leave lights and appliances on standby, how warm to keep their homes and how often to use the car. Switching to efficient bulbs, turning down the thermostat and unplugging unused devices can cut bills as well as emissions. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A household that lowers its heating by one degree and dries clothes on a line, for example, may notice a clear difference in its monthly bill, and the total saving across a whole city is considerable.

On the other hand, others believe that governments must act because individuals alone cannot solve problems that are largely structural. A tenant cannot insulate a landlord's building, and no consumer can choose clean electricity if the national grid still depends on coal. Governments can set rules that apply to everyone, such as efficiency standards for appliances and buildings, and only they can invest in the renewable power and public transport that make low-energy living practical. A family in a poorly insulated rented flat, for instance, loses heat through the walls however careful it is.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that governments should take the lead by setting standards and funding improvements, while individuals make these policies effective through their daily habits.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **energy prices and emissions rise** — giá năng lượng và khí thải tăng
- **saving energy** — tiết kiệm năng lượng
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **on standby** — ở chế độ chờ
- **how warm to keep their homes** — giữ nhà ấm đến mức nào
- **efficient bulbs** — bóng đèn tiết kiệm điện
- **turning down the thermostat** — hạ nhiệt độ bộ điều nhiệt
- **unplugging unused devices** — rút phích thiết bị không dùng
- **cut bills as well as emissions** — giảm cả hoá đơn lẫn khí thải
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **dries clothes on a line** — phơi quần áo trên dây
- **a clear difference in its monthly bill** — khác biệt rõ trong hoá đơn hằng tháng
- **the total saving** — tổng mức tiết kiệm
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **largely structural** — chủ yếu mang tính hệ thống
- **insulate a landlord's building** — cách nhiệt toà nhà của chủ nhà
- **clean electricity** — điện sạch
- **the national grid** — lưới điện quốc gia
- **depends on coal** — phụ thuộc vào than
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **efficiency standards for appliances and buildings** — tiêu chuẩn hiệu suất cho thiết bị và toà nhà
- **low-energy living** — lối sống tiết kiệm năng lượng
- **a poorly insulated rented flat** — căn hộ thuê cách nhiệt kém
- **loses heat through the walls** — mất nhiệt qua tường
- **take the lead** — đi đầu
- **funding improvements** — tài trợ cải tiến
- **effective through their daily habits** — hiệu quả nhờ thói quen hằng ngày

#298 Discuss both views · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that nuclear energy is a safe and efficient power source. Others think it is dangerous. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether nuclear energy is a safe and efficient power source or a dangerous one. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that nuclear power is both safe and efficient. Statistically, it has caused far fewer deaths per unit of electricity than coal, which pollutes the air and harms the health of millions of people. It is also efficient, since a small amount of fuel produces a great deal of energy, and a plant can run day and night whatever the weather. Modern reactors include several layers of protection and are monitored closely by independent regulators. A country with strong safety rules, for example, can operate reactors for decades without a serious incident, while providing steady low-carbon electricity to homes and factories.

On the other hand, critics point out that the consequences of a nuclear accident can be severe and long-lasting. The disasters at Chernobyl and Fukushima forced thousands of people to leave their homes, and some areas remained unusable for years. Radioactive waste must also be stored for thousands of years, and there is a continuing fear that nuclear materials could be stolen or misused. These worries make many citizens uneasy about living near a plant. A rare error in a poorly regulated country, for instance, could affect a whole region. Public trust therefore depends on honest reporting and strong, independent oversight.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that nuclear energy is reasonably safe and efficient where regulation is strong, although it must be accompanied by secure waste storage and open public information.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a safe and efficient power source** — nguồn điện an toàn và hiệu quả
- **Statistically** — về mặt thống kê
- **fewer deaths per unit of electricity** — ít tử vong hơn trên mỗi đơn vị điện
- **harms the health of millions of people** — gây hại sức khoẻ hàng triệu người
- **a small amount of fuel produces a great deal of energy** — một lượng nhỏ nhiên liệu tạo ra rất nhiều năng lượng
- **run day and night whatever the weather** — chạy ngày đêm bất kể thời tiết
- **several layers of protection** — nhiều lớp bảo vệ
- **monitored closely by independent regulators** — được cơ quan quản lý độc lập giám sát chặt
- **strong safety rules** — quy định an toàn mạnh
- **without a serious incident** — không có sự cố nghiêm trọng
- **low-carbon electricity** — điện ít carbon
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **severe and long-lasting** — nghiêm trọng và kéo dài
- **forced thousands of people to leave their homes** — buộc hàng nghìn người rời bỏ nhà
- **unusable for years** — không dùng được nhiều năm
- **Radioactive waste** — chất thải phóng xạ
- **stored for thousands of years** — lưu trữ hàng nghìn năm
- **stolen or misused** — bị đánh cắp hoặc lạm dụng
- **uneasy about living near a plant** — bất an khi sống gần nhà máy
- **a rare error** — một sai sót hiếm gặp
- **a poorly regulated country** — nước quản lý lỏng lẻo
- **affect a whole region** — ảnh hưởng cả vùng
- **reasonably safe** — khá an toàn
- **secure waste storage** — kho chứa chất thải an toàn
- **open public information** — thông tin công khai cho công chúng

#314 Discuss both views · 278 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for wildlife conservation, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Many species are now under threat, and people disagree about who should lead efforts to save them: individuals and communities, or the government. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of personal involvement argue that wildlife conservation succeeds only when ordinary people care about it. Local residents often know their area best, and volunteers who count birds, clean rivers or report injured animals provide help that no official body could afford. Donations to conservation charities also pay for projects that governments overlook. Public interest matters because it persuades politicians to act. A village that protects its own wetland and guides visitors around it, for example, can preserve the habitat while earning a modest income from tourism. Their involvement also builds a sense of ownership, so that protection continues even when official attention moves elsewhere.

On the other hand, advocates of government action point out that conservation on a large scale needs money, laws and coordination that individuals cannot provide. Governments can create national parks, restrict building in sensitive areas and punish illegal hunting, and they alone can negotiate with other countries about species that cross borders, such as migrating birds. Charities and volunteers rely on limited and unpredictable funds, so a long-term plan needs public budgets. A rare species whose habitat is sold for development, for instance, cannot be saved by volunteers alone, and without legal protection a conservation project can disappear overnight when land changes hands.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that governments should provide the legal and financial framework, while individuals and local groups supply the knowledge and enthusiasm that make conservation work.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **under threat** — đang bị đe doạ
- **lead efforts to save them** — dẫn dắt nỗ lực cứu chúng
- **personal involvement** — sự tham gia cá nhân
- **wildlife conservation** — bảo tồn động vật hoang dã
- **know their area best** — hiểu khu vực mình nhất
- **count birds** — đếm chim
- **report injured animals** — báo động vật bị thương
- **no official body could afford** — không cơ quan nào đủ khả năng
- **conservation charities** — tổ chức từ thiện bảo tồn
- **overlook** — bỏ sót
- **persuades politicians to act** — thuyết phục chính trị gia hành động
- **protects its own wetland** — bảo vệ vùng đất ngập nước của mình
- **a modest income from tourism** — thu nhập khiêm tốn từ du lịch
- **on a large scale** — ở quy mô lớn
- **coordination** — sự phối hợp
- **restrict building in sensitive areas** — hạn chế xây dựng ở khu vực nhạy cảm
- **species that cross borders** — loài di cư qua biên giới
- **migrating birds** — chim di cư
- **limited and unpredictable funds** — nguồn quỹ hạn chế và khó đoán
- **public budgets** — ngân sách công
- **the legal and financial framework** — khuôn khổ pháp lý và tài chính

#327 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that urban farming can solve food shortages. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether urban farming can solve food shortages. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that urban farming brings fresh food closer to the people who eat it. Rooftop gardens, vertical farms and community plots use empty space in cities, cut transport distances and give residents access to fresh vegetables that would otherwise be expensive or hard to find. Local food costs less to deliver, loses less on the way and strengthens community ties, since neighbours work together and learn about growing. A block of flats that grows salad leaves on its roof, for example, can supply nearby households and restaurants throughout the year. In districts where fresh produce is scarce, this can improve diets and reduce hunger.

On the other hand, critics point out that urban farms cannot grow enough staple crops to end food shortages. Cities lack the land and water needed for wheat, rice and maize, which feed most of the world, and high rents and energy costs make indoor farms expensive. Most urban farms produce leafy vegetables and herbs, which are valuable but provide few calories. A large city that tried to feed itself from its own rooftops, for instance, would run out of space very quickly, because growing enough rice or wheat for millions of residents requires far more land than any city can spare.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that urban farming is a useful supplement that improves access to fresh food, but it cannot replace rural agriculture or solve shortages on its own.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **urban farming** — nông nghiệp đô thị
- **solve food shortages** — giải quyết thiếu lương thực
- **brings fresh food closer** — đưa thực phẩm tươi lại gần hơn
- **Rooftop gardens** — vườn trên mái nhà
- **vertical farms** — trang trại thẳng đứng
- **community plots** — ô đất cộng đồng
- **cut transport distances** — rút ngắn quãng đường vận chuyển
- **hard to find** — khó tìm
- **loses less on the way** — hao hụt ít hơn trên đường
- **strengthens community ties** — củng cố gắn kết cộng đồng
- **throughout the year** — quanh năm
- **improve diets** — cải thiện chế độ ăn
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **staple crops** — cây lương thực chính
- **the land and water needed for** — đất và nước cần cho
- **high rents and energy costs** — tiền thuê và chi phí năng lượng cao
- **leafy vegetables and herbs** — rau lá và thảo mộc
- **provide few calories** — cung cấp ít calo
- **run out of space** — hết chỗ
- **a useful supplement** — phần bổ sung hữu ích
- **replace rural agriculture** — thay thế nông nghiệp nông thôn

#374 Discuss both views · 303 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for reporting environmental violations, or should society/government act proactively? Discuss.

When factories dump waste or forests are cut down illegally, it is not always clear who should act: citizens who report what they see, or authorities that look for violations themselves. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of public reporting argue that ordinary people are often the first to notice environmental damage. Residents see the smoke from a chimney, the discoloured river or the lorry unloading rubbish at night, and no inspector can be everywhere at once. Reports from the public therefore extend the reach of the authorities at low cost. A community that can report problems easily is also more likely to feel responsible for its surroundings. A fisherman who notices a poisoned stream and phones a hotline, for example, may stop pollution before it spreads to the whole river. In some places, mobile apps now let residents upload photographs of illegal dumping, which gives inspectors evidence that they can act on.

On the other hand, advocates of proactive government action point out that relying on individuals puts the burden on the wrong people. Citizens may not recognise a violation, may fear punishment from a local employer or may simply not bother, so serious offences can go undetected for years. Authorities can carry out regular inspections, use satellite monitoring and impose penalties that deter companies in the first place. An employee who fears losing a job, for instance, is unlikely to report their own factory. Moreover, a company that knows it may be inspected at any time has a stronger reason to follow the rules than one that fears only occasional complaints.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that governments should act proactively and enforce the rules, while making reporting easy and safe so that the public can help.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **dump waste** — xả chất thải
- **cut down illegally** — chặt phá trái phép
- **look for violations** — tìm kiếm vi phạm
- **supporters of public reporting** — người ủng hộ việc người dân báo cáo
- **environmental damage** — thiệt hại môi trường
- **the discoloured river** — dòng sông đổi màu
- **unloading rubbish at night** — đổ rác ban đêm
- **be everywhere at once** — có mặt khắp nơi cùng lúc
- **extend the reach of the authorities** — mở rộng tầm với của chính quyền
- **at low cost** — với chi phí thấp
- **feel responsible for its surroundings** — thấy có trách nhiệm với môi trường quanh mình
- **a hotline** — đường dây nóng
- **stop pollution before it spreads** — chặn ô nhiễm trước khi lan rộng
- **proactive government action** — hành động chủ động của chính phủ
- **puts the burden on the wrong people** — đặt gánh nặng lên nhầm người
- **fear punishment from a local employer** — sợ bị chủ địa phương trừng phạt
- **go undetected for years** — không bị phát hiện suốt nhiều năm
- **regular inspections** — thanh tra định kỳ
- **satellite monitoring** — giám sát bằng vệ tinh
- **deter companies** — răn đe doanh nghiệp

#393 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on climate adaptation or climate mitigation? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether governments should spend more on adapting to climate change or on trying to reduce it. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of adaptation argue that it protects people from harm that is already happening. Sea walls, flood defences, drought-resistant crops and early warning systems save lives and homes within a few years, whereas cuts in emissions take decades to change the climate. Adaptation also helps countries that produce little pollution but suffer its effects, such as small island nations. A coastal town that builds a flood barrier, for example, protects its residents from the next storm, whatever the world does about emissions, and the investment begins to pay back as soon as the barrier is finished.

On the other hand, advocates of mitigation point out that adaptation alone only treats the symptoms. Cutting emissions at their source, through renewable energy, efficient buildings and cleaner transport, reduces the scale of the problem, whereas defences become more expensive and less effective as temperatures rise. Prevention is also far cheaper than dealing with the consequences later, and clean technology can create growth and jobs. A country that relies only on higher sea walls, for instance, must keep rebuilding them as the sea continues to rise. Moreover, long-term projects such as grid upgrades take many years, so delay would make the task harder and more costly.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that mitigation should receive the larger share, since it tackles the cause, although vulnerable communities must still be protected through adaptation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **adapting to climate change** — thích ứng với biến đổi khí hậu
- **reduce it** — giảm nó
- **supporters of adaptation** — người ủng hộ thích ứng
- **harm that is already happening** — tác hại đã đang xảy ra
- **Sea walls** — đê biển
- **flood defences** — công trình chống lũ
- **drought-resistant crops** — cây trồng chịu hạn
- **early warning systems** — hệ thống cảnh báo sớm
- **save lives and homes** — cứu mạng sống và nhà cửa
- **take decades to change the climate** — mất hàng chục năm để thay đổi khí hậu
- **small island nations** — các quốc đảo nhỏ
- **a flood barrier** — rào chắn lũ
- **pay back** — đem lại lợi ích hoàn vốn
- **advocates of mitigation** — người ủng hộ giảm thiểu
- **only treats the symptoms** — chỉ chữa triệu chứng
- **at their source** — tại nguồn
- **efficient buildings** — toà nhà tiết kiệm năng lượng
- **reduces the scale of the problem** — giảm quy mô vấn đề
- **tackles the cause** — giải quyết nguyên nhân
- **vulnerable communities** — cộng đồng dễ tổn thương

#474 Discuss both views · 278 từ · AI 7.5

Should individuals be responsible for reducing e-waste, or should society/government enforce recycling? Discuss.

Discarded phones, computers and televisions are creating a fast-growing waste problem, and opinions differ on whether people should be responsible for reducing it or whether the state should enforce recycling. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of individual responsibility argue that everyday personal choices add up to a large environmental effect. Consumers decide how often to replace a device, whether to repair it and where to dispose of it, and a phone left in a drawer or thrown into household rubbish wastes valuable materials. Buyers who choose durable products also push manufacturers to improve their designs. Without changed habits, even strong laws are hard to enforce. A student who repairs a cracked screen instead of buying a new phone, for example, keeps a device in use for several more years, and millions of similar choices would greatly reduce the pile of electronic waste.

On the other hand, advocates of enforcement point out that individuals alone cannot solve problems that are largely structural. Most people do not know where to take an old device, and many products are deliberately designed to be difficult to repair. Governments can set rules that apply to everyone, such as requiring manufacturers to take back what they sell, and only they can build collection systems and licensed recycling plants. A household with no drop-off point nearby, for instance, will probably keep or discard the device rather than travel far.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that governments should enforce recycling and make producers responsible, since this removes the burden from consumers, while individuals support it by repairing and returning their devices.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Discarded phones, computers and televisions** — điện thoại, máy tính, ti vi bị vứt bỏ
- **a fast-growing waste problem** — vấn đề rác thải tăng nhanh
- **enforce recycling** — bắt buộc tái chế
- **everyday personal choices** — lựa chọn cá nhân hằng ngày
- **add up to a large environmental effect** — cộng lại thành tác động môi trường lớn
- **how often to replace a device** — bao lâu thay thiết bị một lần
- **dispose of it** — vứt bỏ nó
- **left in a drawer** — bỏ trong ngăn kéo
- **wastes valuable materials** — lãng phí nguyên liệu quý
- **durable products** — sản phẩm bền
- **improve their designs** — cải thiện thiết kế
- **hard to enforce** — khó thực thi
- **repairs a cracked screen** — sửa màn hình bị nứt
- **in use for several more years** — còn dùng thêm nhiều năm
- **the pile of electronic waste** — đống rác điện tử
- **advocates of enforcement** — người ủng hộ thực thi nghiêm
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **largely structural** — chủ yếu mang tính hệ thống
- **designed to be difficult to repair** — được thiết kế khó sửa
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **take back what they sell** — thu hồi thứ họ bán
- **collection systems** — hệ thống thu gom
- **licensed recycling plants** — nhà máy tái chế có giấy phép
- **make producers responsible** — buộc nhà sản xuất chịu trách nhiệm
- **removes the burden from consumers** — gỡ gánh nặng khỏi người tiêu dùng

#486 Discuss both views · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on organic farming or on other priorities? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be spent on organic farming or on other priorities such as health and education. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of organic farming argue that it reduces chemical use and protects soil and wildlife. Organic farmers avoid synthetic pesticides and fertilisers, which keeps soil healthy, protects rivers from chemical runoff and supports insects, birds and other wildlife. Many consumers also prefer organic food and are willing to pay more for it, so public support can help farmers to enter a growing market. A farm that rotates crops and uses natural compost, for example, may improve its soil year after year while producing food with fewer chemical residues.

On the other hand, critics point out that governments have limited funds and many equally urgent responsibilities. Hospitals, schools, housing and welfare all need money now, and organic farming has drawbacks. Yields are usually lower, so more land is needed to produce the same amount of food, and organic products are often more expensive, which makes them hard to afford for poorer families. Spending large sums on one method of farming may therefore bring little benefit compared with spending on public services. A town with overcrowded classrooms, for instance, has more pressing needs than a grant for organic growers. Money spent on health and education also tends to bring benefits that last for many years.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that other priorities should receive most of the budget, with modest and targeted support for sustainable farming where the environmental benefits are clear.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **organic farming** — nông nghiệp hữu cơ
- **other priorities** — các ưu tiên khác
- **reduces chemical use** — giảm dùng hoá chất
- **protects soil and wildlife** — bảo vệ đất và động vật hoang dã
- **synthetic pesticides and fertilisers** — thuốc trừ sâu và phân bón tổng hợp
- **keeps soil healthy** — giữ đất khoẻ mạnh
- **chemical runoff** — nước thải hoá chất chảy tràn
- **willing to pay more** — sẵn sàng trả nhiều hơn
- **a growing market** — thị trường đang tăng trưởng
- **rotates crops** — luân canh cây trồng
- **natural compost** — phân hữu cơ tự nhiên
- **fewer chemical residues** — ít dư lượng hoá chất hơn
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **governments have limited funds and many equally urgent responsibilities** — chính phủ có ngân sách hạn hẹp và nhiều trách nhiệm cấp bách ngang nhau
- **need money now** — cần tiền ngay bây giờ
- **Yields are usually lower** — năng suất thường thấp hơn
- **more land is needed** — cần nhiều đất hơn
- **hard to afford** — khó mua nổi
- **bring little benefit** — mang lại ít lợi ích
- **public services** — dịch vụ công
- **overcrowded classrooms** — lớp học quá đông
- **more pressing needs than** — có nhu cầu cấp thiết hơn
- **modest and targeted support** — hỗ trợ khiêm tốn và có mục tiêu
- **sustainable farming** — nông nghiệp bền vững

#498 Discuss both views · 275 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on climate change or on other priorities? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be directed mainly at climate change or at other priorities such as health and education. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of other priorities argue that governments have limited funds and many equally urgent responsibilities. Hospitals, schools, housing and welfare all need money now, and a patient waiting for treatment or a child in an overcrowded classroom cannot wait for the long-term benefits of climate policy. In poorer countries especially, spending heavily on emissions cuts may seem a luxury when basic needs are unmet. A town with no emergency hospital, for example, has more pressing needs than a new solar farm.

On the other hand, advocates of climate spending point out that ignoring the environment is expensive in the long run. Floods, heatwaves and droughts destroy homes and farmland, and the cost of repairing the damage later is usually far higher than the cost of preventing it. Climate spending can also create growth and jobs in renewable energy, insulation and public transport, and it reduces illness caused by air pollution, so it supports health as well as the environment. A government that builds flood defences today, for instance, saves far more than it spends when a storm arrives. Delay is therefore a costly choice, because every year without action locks in more emissions that later governments must pay to remove.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that climate action deserves a substantial share of spending, because its costs rise the longer it is delayed, while essential services must still be protected.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **directed mainly at climate change** — chủ yếu dành cho biến đổi khí hậu
- **other priorities** — các ưu tiên khác
- **governments have limited funds and many equally urgent responsibilities** — chính phủ có ngân sách hạn hẹp và nhiều trách nhiệm cấp bách ngang nhau
- **need money now** — cần tiền ngay bây giờ
- **an overcrowded classroom** — lớp học quá đông
- **cannot wait for** — không thể chờ
- **long-term benefits** — lợi ích dài hạn
- **spending heavily on emissions cuts** — chi nhiều cho cắt giảm khí thải
- **seem a luxury** — có vẻ xa xỉ
- **basic needs are unmet** — nhu cầu cơ bản chưa được đáp ứng
- **more pressing needs than** — có nhu cầu cấp thiết hơn
- **a new solar farm** — trang trại điện mặt trời mới
- **advocates of climate spending** — người ủng hộ chi cho khí hậu
- **ignoring the environment** — phớt lờ môi trường
- **expensive in the long run** — đắt về lâu dài
- **destroy homes and farmland** — phá nhà cửa và đất canh tác
- **repairing the damage later** — sửa chữa thiệt hại sau này
- **illness caused by air pollution** — bệnh do ô nhiễm không khí
- **builds flood defences** — xây công trình chống lũ
- **a substantial share of spending** — phần chi tiêu đáng kể
- **costs rise the longer it is delayed** — chi phí tăng khi càng trì hoãn

Opinion

#11 Opinion · 268 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 8.0)

In your opinion, should countries invest more in renewable energy? Explain why.

Rising fuel prices and worries about pollution have made energy a central political issue. I firmly believe that countries should invest more in renewable energy, since it reduces pollution and carbon emissions and also strengthens energy security.

To begin with, renewable energy is cleaner than coal, oil and gas. Solar panels and wind turbines produce electricity without burning fuel, so they release almost no greenhouse gases and none of the smoke that harms people's lungs in crowded cities. The sun and wind will not run out, whereas fossil fuels are limited and their extraction damages land and water. A city that replaces a coal power station with wind and solar farms, for example, can breathe cleaner air within a few years, and hospitals may treat fewer patients with breathing problems.

Furthermore, investing in renewables makes a country less dependent on imported fuel. Nations that buy oil and gas from abroad are exposed to sudden price rises and political disputes, while home-grown wind and solar power gives them a more stable and secure supply. Spending on renewable technology also creates employment in manufacturing, installation and maintenance, and the cost of solar and wind equipment has fallen as the technology has improved. Admittedly, the sun does not always shine and the wind does not always blow, so countries need batteries and flexible grids, but this cost is modest compared with the benefits. Over time, cheaper clean power can also help ordinary households and businesses to cut their energy bills.

In conclusion, I believe that countries should invest more in renewable energy, because it is cleaner, more secure and increasingly affordable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Rising fuel prices** — giá nhiên liệu tăng
- **a central political issue** — vấn đề chính trị trung tâm
- **invest more in renewable energy** — đầu tư nhiều hơn vào năng lượng tái tạo
- **reduces pollution and carbon emissions** — giảm ô nhiễm và khí thải carbon
- **strengthens energy security** — củng cố an ninh năng lượng
- **without burning fuel** — không đốt nhiên liệu
- **release almost no greenhouse gases** — thải gần như không khí nhà kính
- **harms people's lungs** — gây hại phổi người
- **will not run out** — sẽ không cạn kiệt
- **their extraction damages land and water** — việc khai thác chúng làm hại đất và nước
- **breathe cleaner air** — hít thở không khí sạch hơn
- **breathing problems** — vấn đề hô hấp
- **dependent on imported fuel** — phụ thuộc vào nhiên liệu nhập khẩu
- **exposed to sudden price rises** — chịu ảnh hưởng của việc giá tăng đột ngột
- **political disputes** — tranh chấp chính trị
- **home-grown wind and solar power** — điện gió và mặt trời sản xuất trong nước
- **a more stable and secure supply** — nguồn cung ổn định và an toàn hơn
- **creates employment** — tạo việc làm
- **installation and maintenance** — lắp đặt và bảo trì
- **batteries and flexible grids** — pin và lưới điện linh hoạt
- **clean power** — điện sạch
- **cut their energy bills** — giảm hoá đơn năng lượng

#276 Opinion · 271 từ · AI 8.0

Discuss how community gardens benefit neighborhoods.

In many cities, small plots of land are used by residents to grow vegetables, herbs and flowers together. This essay will outline two key ways in which community gardens benefit neighbourhoods: by bringing people together and by providing fresh food and green space.

First and foremost, community gardens bring neighbours together. Residents grow vegetables on unused land, share skills and tools, and meet people from different backgrounds, which strengthens friendships and reduces loneliness. A vacant plot turned into a vegetable garden, for example, can become a place where neighbours meet instead of a spot where rubbish collects. Children learn where food comes from, and older residents pass on knowledge and enjoy the company. Working on a shared project builds trust, so neighbourhoods with such gardens often feel safer and friendlier, and people are more willing to help one another.

In addition, community gardens provide fresh food and improve the local environment. Households that grow their own produce save money on groceries and eat more vegetables, which supports healthy diets, especially in areas with few fresh food shops. The gardens also turn neglected land into green space that cools the air, shelters insects and birds and absorbs rainwater. Gardening is a gentle form of exercise and can reduce stress, which benefits mental wellbeing. Although a garden needs volunteers and some funding for tools and water, councils can help by lending land and offering advice, and the benefits to the neighbourhood far outweigh the small cost.

To sum up, community gardens benefit neighbourhoods by building community spirit and by providing fresh food and green space. For these reasons, they deserve continued public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **community gardens** — vườn cộng đồng
- **benefit neighbourhoods** — mang lại lợi ích cho khu dân cư
- **bringing people together** — gắn kết mọi người
- **fresh food and green space** — thực phẩm tươi và không gian xanh
- **unused land** — đất không dùng
- **share skills and tools** — chia sẻ kỹ năng và dụng cụ
- **different backgrounds** — xuất thân khác nhau
- **reduces loneliness** — giảm cô đơn
- **a vacant plot** — lô đất trống
- **a spot where rubbish collects** — chỗ rác tích tụ
- **pass on knowledge** — truyền lại kinh nghiệm
- **Working on a shared project builds trust** — làm việc chung một dự án xây dựng lòng tin
- **safer and friendlier** — an toàn và thân thiện hơn
- **save money on groceries** — tiết kiệm tiền đi chợ
- **healthy diets** — chế độ ăn lành mạnh
- **neglected land** — đất bị bỏ quên
- **green space** — không gian xanh
- **absorbs rainwater** — hấp thụ nước mưa
- **a gentle form of exercise** — một dạng vận động nhẹ nhàng
- **reduce stress** — giảm căng thẳng
- **lending land and offering advice** — cho mượn đất và tư vấn
- **community spirit** — tinh thần cộng đồng
- **deserve continued public support** — xứng đáng được hỗ trợ công liên tục

Causes / Solutions

#22 Causes / Solutions · 277 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 8.0)

How can governments encourage recycling? Suggest practical measures.

Recycling saves raw materials and keeps rubbish out of landfill, yet in many places a large share of recyclable material is still thrown away. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on making recycling easy and on giving people a reason to take part.

To begin with, governments should make recycling convenient. Households are more likely to sort their rubbish if collection is regular, bins are clearly marked and the rules are simple. Colour-coded containers, weekly kerbside collection and public recycling points in busy areas remove the effort from the process. Only governments can build the sorting plants and collection networks that make recycling practical. A resident with no collection point nearby, for example, has little chance of recycling even when they want to. Clear labels on packaging, which show what can be recycled, would also reduce confusion.

In addition, authorities should give people good reasons to take part. Deposit schemes, in which customers receive a small refund for returning bottles and cans, raise return rates sharply, and lower charges for households that produce less general waste reward careful sorting. Education campaigns in schools and on local media explain why recycling matters and how to do it correctly. Equally important, governments can require manufacturers to use recycled material, which creates a market for what households collect. A council that publishes how much material each neighbourhood recycles, for instance, can encourage friendly competition and steady improvement. These steps cost little compared with the expense of extracting new raw materials.

In conclusion, making recycling convenient and rewarding, through better services, deposits, education and demand for recycled materials, offers the most realistic way of increasing participation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **saves raw materials** — tiết kiệm nguyên liệu
- **keeps rubbish out of landfill** — giữ rác khỏi bãi chôn lấp
- **a large share of recyclable material** — phần lớn vật liệu tái chế được
- **thrown away** — bị vứt đi
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **a reason to take part** — lý do để tham gia
- **sort their rubbish** — phân loại rác
- **collection is regular** — việc thu gom đều đặn
- **clearly marked** — được đánh dấu rõ
- **the rules are simple** — quy tắc đơn giản
- **Colour-coded containers** — thùng mã màu
- **weekly kerbside collection** — thu gom hằng tuần ở lề đường
- **public recycling points** — điểm tái chế công cộng
- **remove the effort from the process** — loại bỏ công sức khỏi quá trình
- **sorting plants** — nhà máy phân loại
- **Clear labels on packaging** — nhãn rõ ràng trên bao bì
- **reduce confusion** — giảm nhầm lẫn
- **deposit schemes** — chương trình đặt cọc vỏ chai
- **a small refund for returning bottles** — khoản hoàn nhỏ khi trả chai
- **raise return rates** — tăng tỷ lệ trả lại
- **lower charges for households** — phí thấp hơn cho hộ gia đình
- **reward careful sorting** — thưởng cho việc phân loại cẩn thận
- **use recycled material** — dùng vật liệu tái chế
- **creates a market for** — tạo ra thị trường cho
- **friendly competition** — cạnh tranh thân thiện
- **extracting new raw materials** — khai thác nguyên liệu mới
- **participation** — sự tham gia

#82 Causes / Solutions · 271 từ · AI 8.0

How can governments reduce plastic waste? Suggest practical measures.

Plastic waste is polluting oceans, rivers and land in almost every country. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on reducing the production of plastic items and on improving recycling and clean-up.

To begin with, governments can reduce the amount of plastic that enters the market. Banning or taxing single-use items such as bags, cups and straws encourages people to switch to reusable alternatives, and requiring manufacturers to use less packaging cuts waste at its source. A small charge for plastic bags, for example, has reduced their use sharply in several countries. Governments can also require producers to pay for the collection and recycling of the packaging they sell, which gives companies a reason to design products that are easier to recycle and to avoid unnecessary wrapping altogether.

In addition, authorities should improve collection and recycling systems. Deposit schemes, in which customers receive a small refund for returning bottles, raise return rates and keep bottles out of the environment. Investment in sorting plants and regular collection makes recycling practical for households, and public education campaigns explain which items can be recycled. Equally important, clean-up programmes and stricter penalties for dumping protect rivers and beaches. A town that offers a refund for every returned bottle, for instance, often finds that litter along its streets falls and that the material is reused instead of wasted. These measures are not expensive compared with the long-term cost of polluted seas and damaged wildlife.

In conclusion, reducing plastic production through bans, charges and producer responsibility, and improving recycling through deposits and better infrastructure, offer the most realistic way of cutting plastic waste.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Plastic waste** — rác thải nhựa
- **polluting oceans, rivers and land** — làm ô nhiễm đại dương, sông và đất
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **the production of plastic items** — việc sản xuất đồ nhựa
- **recycling and clean-up** — tái chế và dọn dẹp
- **enters the market** — đi vào thị trường
- **Banning or taxing single-use items** — cấm hoặc đánh thuế đồ dùng một lần
- **switch to reusable alternatives** — chuyển sang đồ dùng lại được
- **cuts waste at its source** — cắt giảm rác tại nguồn
- **a small charge for plastic bags** — khoản phí nhỏ cho túi nhựa
- **has reduced their use sharply** — đã giảm mạnh việc dùng chúng
- **pay for the collection and recycling** — trả phí thu gom và tái chế
- **easier to recycle** — dễ tái chế hơn
- **unnecessary wrapping** — lớp bọc không cần thiết
- **deposit schemes** — chương trình đặt cọc vỏ chai
- **a small refund for returning bottles** — khoản hoàn nhỏ khi trả chai
- **raise return rates** — tăng tỷ lệ trả lại
- **sorting plants** — nhà máy phân loại
- **makes recycling practical** — làm tái chế khả thi
- **public education campaigns** — chiến dịch giáo dục cộng đồng
- **stricter penalties for dumping** — hình phạt nghiêm hơn cho đổ rác
- **litter along its streets falls** — rác dọc đường phố giảm

#122 Causes / Solutions · 275 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments improve urban green spaces? Suggest practical measures.

Cities offer jobs and services, but many of them lack parks, trees and open space, which makes life hotter, noisier and less healthy. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on protecting and creating green space and on keeping it well maintained and accessible.

To begin with, governments can protect and expand green space inside cities. Planning rules can protect existing parks, require new developments to include gardens and playgrounds, and encourage green roofs and street trees where land is scarce. Unused sites, such as old car parks or empty plots, can be turned into small parks at low cost. A block of flats with a planted roof, for example, stays cooler in summer and offers residents a small garden. Over time, a network of connected green areas can help to cool the city, absorb pollution and shelter birds and insects.

In addition, authorities should make sure that green spaces are well maintained and accessible to everyone. Parks that are dirty or unsafe are rarely used, so councils need to budget for cleaning, lighting, repair and sensible security. Facilities such as paths, benches and play areas should be suitable for children, older people and people with disabilities, and parks should be located in poorer districts as well as wealthy ones. Equally important, involving residents in the design and care of their local park, through volunteer groups or consultations, encourages pride and reduces vandalism. These measures are inexpensive compared with the health and social benefits that they bring.

In conclusion, protecting and creating green spaces and then maintaining them for all residents offers the most realistic way of improving urban green areas.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **lack parks, trees and open space** — thiếu công viên, cây xanh và không gian mở
- **hotter, noisier and less healthy** — nóng hơn, ồn hơn và kém lành mạnh hơn
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **green space** — không gian xanh
- **well maintained and accessible** — được bảo trì tốt và dễ tiếp cận
- **protect and expand green space** — bảo vệ và mở rộng không gian xanh
- **Planning rules** — quy tắc quy hoạch
- **require new developments to include gardens** — yêu cầu dự án mới có vườn
- **green roofs and street trees** — mái xanh và cây đường phố
- **where land is scarce** — nơi đất khan hiếm
- **old car parks or empty plots** — bãi đỗ xe cũ hoặc lô đất trống
- **at low cost** — với chi phí thấp
- **stays cooler in summer** — mát hơn vào mùa hè
- **a network of connected green areas** — mạng lưới khu xanh kết nối
- **cool the city, absorb pollution** — làm mát thành phố, hấp thụ ô nhiễm
- **shelter birds and insects** — che chở chim và côn trùng
- **dirty or unsafe** — bẩn hoặc không an toàn
- **cleaning, lighting, repair and sensible security** — dọn dẹp, chiếu sáng, sửa chữa và an ninh hợp lý
- **people with disabilities** — người khuyết tật
- **poorer districts as well as wealthy ones** — khu nghèo cũng như khu giàu
- **encourages pride and reduces vandalism** — khuyến khích niềm tự hào và giảm phá hoại
- **health and social benefits** — lợi ích sức khoẻ và xã hội

#169 Causes / Solutions · 275 từ · AI 7.5

What are the causes of air pollution in industrial cities? What solutions can be proposed?

Industrial cities offer jobs and growth, but their air is often thick with smoke and dust. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Factories, coal power stations and traffic are the main causes of air pollution in industrial cities. They release smoke, dust and gases such as sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides, and the problem is worse when cities are crowded or surrounded by hills that trap polluted air. A city with many coal-burning factories in a valley, for example, may be covered in smog for weeks in winter. In addition, old vehicles and heavy lorries add fumes to the air at street level, and construction work and open burning of waste raise the amount of dust. Residents then suffer from breathing problems and heart disease, and the cost of health care rises.

To address this issue, strict emission limits and cleaner energy would reduce air pollution. Filters and emission limits cut what factories release, clean electricity from wind, solar and gas can replace coal, and better public transport and electric vehicles reduce traffic fumes. Governments should enforce these rules with inspections and meaningful fines, and help small firms to afford cleaner equipment. In addition, air quality monitoring and green belts help to track progress and absorb pollutants, and public warnings allow vulnerable people to protect themselves on bad days. Cities that have cleaned their air in this way have usually found that the improvement in health and productivity more than repays the cost.

In conclusion, air pollution in industrial cities stems mainly from factories, coal power and traffic, but strict limits, cleaner energy and monitoring offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Industrial cities** — thành phố công nghiệp
- **thick with smoke and dust** — dày đặc khói và bụi
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **coal power stations** — nhà máy điện than
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides** — khí SO2 và NOx
- **crowded or surrounded by hills** — đông đúc hoặc bị đồi bao quanh
- **trap polluted air** — giữ không khí ô nhiễm
- **covered in smog for weeks** — bị phủ khói bụi hàng tuần
- **old vehicles and heavy lorries** — xe cũ và xe tải nặng
- **at street level** — ở tầm đường phố
- **open burning of waste** — đốt rác ngoài trời
- **suffer from breathing problems** — bị các vấn đề hô hấp
- **the cost of health care rises** — chi phí y tế tăng
- **strict emission limits** — giới hạn khí thải nghiêm ngặt
- **cleaner energy** — năng lượng sạch hơn
- **emission limits** — giới hạn khí thải
- **cut what factories release** — giảm thứ nhà máy thải ra
- **clean electricity** — điện sạch
- **inspections and meaningful fines** — thanh tra và tiền phạt có ý nghĩa
- **air quality monitoring** — giám sát chất lượng không khí
- **green belts** — vành đai xanh
- **more than repays the cost** — vượt hơn chi phí bỏ ra
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

#242 Causes / Solutions · 278 từ · AI 8.0

How can governments reduce littering in public places? Suggest practical measures.

Crisp packets, cigarette ends and drink containers left on streets and in parks spoil public spaces and harm wildlife. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on making it easy to dispose of rubbish properly and on discouraging people who drop it.

To begin with, governments should make proper disposal easy. People are more likely to use a bin if one is close by, so councils should place well-marked bins in busy streets, near bus stops and at park entrances, and empty them often so that they do not overflow. Separate containers for recycling and general rubbish, with clear symbols, help people to do the right thing quickly. A park with a bin every fifty metres, for example, will usually be cleaner than one with only a few. Clean surroundings also set an example, because people tend to drop rubbish where litter already exists, so regular cleaning is part of the solution.

In addition, authorities should discourage careless behaviour. Visible fines for dropping litter, supported by patrols or cameras in problem areas, make people think twice, and community service for repeat offenders can be an effective penalty. Equally important, public campaigns and school lessons can change attitudes by explaining the harm that litter causes to animals and neighbourhoods. Deposit schemes for bottles and cans also give containers a value, so that people return them instead of dropping them. A town that combines more bins, fines and a deposit scheme, for instance, may see litter fall sharply within a year.

In conclusion, providing convenient bins and enforcing penalties, together with education and deposit schemes, offers the most realistic way of reducing littering in public places.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Crisp packets, cigarette ends and drink containers** — gói snack, tàn thuốc và vỏ đồ uống
- **spoil public spaces** — làm hỏng không gian công cộng
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **dispose of rubbish properly** — vứt rác đúng cách
- **discouraging** — gây nản lòng
- **drop it** — vứt nó xuống
- **make proper disposal easy** — làm cho việc vứt rác đúng cách dễ dàng
- **close by** — ở gần
- **well-marked bins** — thùng rác dễ nhận biết
- **near bus stops** — gần trạm xe buýt
- **do not overflow** — không bị tràn
- **clear symbols** — biểu tượng rõ ràng
- **do the right thing** — làm điều đúng
- **Clean surroundings also set an example** — môi trường sạch cũng làm gương
- **litter already exists** — rác đã có sẵn
- **discourage careless behaviour** — ngăn hành vi cẩu thả
- **Visible fines** — tiền phạt công khai
- **patrols or cameras** — tuần tra hoặc camera
- **make people think twice** — khiến người ta cân nhắc lại
- **community service for repeat offenders** — lao động công ích cho người tái phạm
- **change attitudes** — thay đổi thái độ
- **deposit schemes** — chương trình đặt cọc vỏ chai
- **give containers a value** — cho vỏ chai một giá trị
- **fall sharply within a year** — giảm mạnh trong một năm

#451 Causes / Solutions · 287 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of food waste in developed countries? What solutions can be proposed?

Wealthy countries throw away large quantities of edible food every day, which wastes money and resources. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Overbuying and strict rules about appearance and dates are major causes of food waste. Shoppers often buy more than they need, attracted by bulk offers and large packs, and food then spoils in the fridge before it can be eaten. Many people also misunderstand date labels and discard products that are still safe. In addition, supermarkets and producers reject fruit and vegetables that are the wrong size or shape, even though they taste the same, and restaurants serve portions that are larger than customers can finish. A bag of misshapen carrots that never reaches the shelf, for example, is wasted before anyone has a chance to eat it.

To address this issue, governments should require clearer labels and encourage retailers to sell imperfect produce at lower prices. Laws or incentives can make supermarkets pass unsold but edible food to charities and food banks, as some countries already do, so that surplus feeds people instead of landfill. Education campaigns in schools and on social media can teach households to plan meals, store food properly and use leftovers. Councils can also provide food-waste collection for composting or energy production. These measures are inexpensive compared with the money and resources lost when food is thrown away, and they help families to cut their grocery bills. Such steps would turn a hidden loss into a saving for households, retailers and the environment alike.

In conclusion, food waste in developed countries stems mainly from overbuying and from strict appearance and date standards, but clearer labels, redistribution of surplus and education offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Wealthy countries** — các nước giàu
- **large quantities of edible food** — lượng lớn thực phẩm ăn được
- **wastes money and resources** — lãng phí tiền và nguồn lực
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **Overbuying** — mua quá nhiều
- **strict rules about appearance and dates** — quy định khắt khe về hình thức và hạn dùng
- **attracted by bulk offers and large packs** — bị hấp dẫn bởi khuyến mãi mua nhiều và gói lớn
- **spoils in the fridge** — hỏng trong tủ lạnh
- **misunderstand date labels** — hiểu sai nhãn hạn dùng
- **still safe** — vẫn an toàn
- **the wrong size or shape** — sai kích cỡ hoặc hình dạng
- **portions that are larger than customers can finish** — khẩu phần lớn hơn khách ăn hết
- **misshapen carrots** — cà rốt méo mó
- **clearer labels** — nhãn rõ ràng hơn
- **imperfect produce** — nông sản không hoàn hảo
- **pass unsold but edible food to charities** — chuyển thực phẩm chưa bán nhưng ăn được cho tổ chức từ thiện
- **food banks** — ngân hàng thực phẩm
- **surplus feeds people instead of landfill** — phần dư nuôi người thay vì chôn lấp
- **plan meals, store food properly and use leftovers** — lên kế hoạch bữa ăn, bảo quản đúng và dùng đồ thừa
- **food-waste collection** — thu gom rác thực phẩm
- **thrown away** — bị vứt đi
- **cut their grocery bills** — giảm hoá đơn đi chợ
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

#464 Causes / Solutions · 273 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments encourage homeowners to improve insulation? Suggest practical measures.

Heating and cooling homes uses a large share of a country's energy, and a poorly insulated house wastes much of it. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on reducing the cost of insulation and on setting rules and giving advice.

To begin with, governments can make home insulation cheaper and easier. Grants, low-interest loans and tax rebates remove the high upfront cost, which is the main reason many families delay improvements, and local schemes can offer to install insulation at a reduced price. A family that insulates its loft and walls, for example, may notice a clear fall in its heating bills within a single winter. Because the savings continue every year, the payments can often be recovered over time. Targeted help for low-income households is especially valuable, since they spend a larger share of their income on energy.

In addition, authorities should use rules and information to encourage action. Minimum standards for new buildings and rented homes ensure that landlords cannot ignore the problem, because tenants often cannot make improvements themselves. Free energy checks show owners what to fix first, and a clear rating on every property helps buyers and renters to compare homes. Public campaigns can explain how much money and energy can be saved, and training for local builders makes sure that work is done properly. Together, these measures help households to save money while national emissions fall, and the cost to the government is modest compared with building new power stations.

In conclusion, cutting the cost of insulation and combining standards with advice offer the most realistic way of encouraging homeowners to improve insulation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Heating and cooling homes** — sưởi và làm mát nhà
- **a large share of a country's energy** — phần lớn năng lượng của một quốc gia
- **a poorly insulated house** — ngôi nhà cách nhiệt kém
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **reducing the cost of insulation** — giảm chi phí cách nhiệt
- **setting rules and giving advice** — đặt quy định và đưa lời khuyên
- **make home insulation cheaper and easier** — làm việc cách nhiệt nhà rẻ và dễ hơn
- **Grants, low-interest loans and tax rebates** — trợ cấp, vay lãi thấp và hoàn thuế
- **the high upfront cost** — chi phí ban đầu cao
- **delay improvements** — trì hoãn cải tạo
- **insulates its loft and walls** — cách nhiệt mái và tường
- **a clear fall in its heating bills** — hoá đơn sưởi giảm rõ rệt
- **Targeted help for low-income households** — hỗ trợ có mục tiêu cho hộ thu nhập thấp
- **Minimum standards for new buildings and rented homes** — tiêu chuẩn tối thiểu cho nhà mới và nhà cho thuê
- **tenants often cannot make improvements themselves** — người thuê thường không tự cải tạo được
- **Free energy checks** — kiểm tra năng lượng miễn phí
- **what to fix first** — nên sửa gì trước
- **a clear rating on every property** — xếp hạng rõ ràng cho mỗi bất động sản
- **training for local builders** — đào tạo thợ xây địa phương
- **done properly** — được làm đúng cách
- **national emissions fall** — khí thải quốc gia giảm
- **power stations** — nhà máy điện

Extent

#33 Extent · 274 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think renewable energy will change in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Solar panels and wind turbines have moved from the margins to the centre of energy planning in many countries. I believe that renewable energy will change considerably over the next twenty years, becoming cheaper, more reliable and far more widely used, although fossil fuels will not disappear completely.

First and foremost, technology and costs are moving in a favourable direction. The cost of solar and wind equipment has fallen as the technology has improved and factories have grown larger, and further progress is likely to make clean power competitive with coal and gas almost everywhere. As a result, utilities and households will choose renewables on price alone, without needing generous subsidies. A homeowner who installs solar panels, for example, may soon recover the cost through lower electricity bills within a few years.

In addition, storage and smarter grids will help to solve the problem that the sun does not always shine and the wind does not always blow. Better batteries can store surplus energy for use at night or in calm weather, and flexible grids can balance supply and demand across large areas. These improvements will make renewable power dependable enough to supply a large share of electricity. However, change will have limits. Heavy industry, aviation and shipping are hard to run on electricity, and many developing countries still rely on cheap coal. Old power stations also last for decades, so the shift will be gradual rather than sudden.

In conclusion, renewable energy is likely to change the way the world produces power to a large extent, thanks to falling costs and better storage, although a full transition will take longer than twenty years.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **from the margins to the centre** — từ rìa vào trung tâm
- **energy planning** — quy hoạch năng lượng
- **change considerably** — thay đổi đáng kể
- **far more widely used** — được dùng rộng rãi hơn nhiều
- **will not disappear completely** — sẽ không biến mất hoàn toàn
- **moving in a favourable direction** — đang đi theo hướng thuận lợi
- **clean power** — điện sạch
- **competitive with coal and gas** — cạnh tranh được với than và khí
- **generous subsidies** — trợ cấp hào phóng
- **recover the cost** — thu hồi chi phí
- **smarter grids** — lưới điện thông minh hơn
- **store surplus energy** — lưu trữ năng lượng dư
- **in calm weather** — khi trời lặng gió
- **balance supply and demand** — cân bằng cung và cầu
- **dependable enough** — đủ đáng tin cậy
- **a large share of electricity** — phần lớn điện năng
- **hard to run on electricity** — khó chạy bằng điện
- **rely on cheap coal** — dựa vào than rẻ
- **power stations** — nhà máy điện
- **gradual rather than sudden** — dần dần thay vì đột ngột
- **falling costs and better storage** — chi phí giảm và lưu trữ tốt hơn
- **a full transition** — chuyển đổi hoàn toàn

#40 Extent · 269 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent should environmental protection influence government policy? Give reasons for your answer.

Governments must balance many aims, from jobs to security, and some people argue that environmental protection should shape policy in every area. I largely agree, since ignoring the environment is expensive in the long run and many problems cannot be solved by markets alone, although it should not override all other goals.

To begin with, the damage caused by neglect is costly. Floods, droughts and polluted air harm crops, homes and health, and the cost of cleaning up afterwards is usually far higher than the cost of preventing the damage. A government that allows a river to become heavily polluted, for example, must later pay for water treatment and for the illnesses that follow, which wastes money that could have funded schools or hospitals. Taking the environment into account when planning policy therefore protects public finances as well as nature.

Furthermore, only governments can set rules that apply to everyone. Individual companies and households have little reason to cut pollution if their competitors do not, so taxes, limits and fines are needed to create a level playing field. Policy can also create growth and employment, since renewable energy, insulation and recycling employ workers and encourage new technology. However, environmental concerns cannot be the only factor. Poorer countries need affordable energy and jobs, and unrealistic rules may cause hardship or political opposition. Policies should therefore be introduced gradually and supported by help for the communities that are affected most.

In conclusion, environmental protection should influence government policy to a large extent, because it saves money in the long term and requires collective rules, provided that its costs are shared fairly.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **balance many aims** — cân bằng nhiều mục tiêu
- **shape policy in every area** — định hình chính sách ở mọi lĩnh vực
- **ignoring the environment** — phớt lờ môi trường
- **expensive in the long run** — đắt về lâu dài
- **cannot be solved by markets alone** — không thể chỉ giải quyết bằng thị trường
- **override all other goals** — lấn át mọi mục tiêu khác
- **the damage caused by neglect** — thiệt hại do bỏ mặc
- **Floods, droughts and polluted air** — lũ, hạn hán và không khí ô nhiễm
- **harm crops, homes and health** — gây hại mùa màng, nhà cửa và sức khoẻ
- **cleaning up afterwards** — dọn dẹp sau đó
- **far higher than the cost of preventing the damage** — cao hơn nhiều so với chi phí ngăn thiệt hại
- **water treatment** — xử lý nước
- **the illnesses that follow** — những bệnh tật theo sau
- **wastes money that could have funded schools** — lãng phí tiền lẽ ra đủ xây trường
- **protects public finances** — bảo vệ tài chính công
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **have little reason to cut pollution** — ít có lý do giảm ô nhiễm
- **taxes, limits and fines** — thuế, giới hạn và tiền phạt
- **create a level playing field** — tạo sân chơi bình đẳng
- **create growth and employment** — tạo tăng trưởng và việc làm
- **encourage new technology** — khuyến khích công nghệ mới
- **unrealistic rules** — quy định phi thực tế
- **cause hardship or political opposition** — gây khó khăn hoặc phản đối chính trị
- **introduced gradually** — được áp dụng dần dần
- **requires collective rules** — đòi hỏi luật lệ chung
- **shared fairly** — được chia sẻ công bằng

#50 Extent · 275 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that public transport is the main way to reduce pollution. To what extent do you agree?

Traffic jams and exhaust fumes make air pollution a daily problem in many cities, and some people argue that public transport is the main way to reduce it. I partly agree, since public transport can cut pollution significantly, but it is one of several measures rather than the only answer.

To begin with, public transport carries many people with far less pollution per passenger. A full bus or train replaces dozens of cars, which reduces exhaust fumes, congestion and the space needed for roads. Cities with frequent, reliable and affordable services often see fewer private cars on the road, and the air in busy streets becomes cleaner and quieter. A commuter who switches from a car to a tram, for example, cuts their share of emissions every day. Public transport also saves time and money, so people are more likely to continue using it.

However, public transport is not the main way to reduce pollution on its own. Much pollution comes from factories, power stations and heating, which buses and trains do not affect. Even within transport, other measures matter: electric vehicles remove tailpipe emissions, cycling and walking produce none, and better urban planning reduces the distances that people need to travel. Public transport also works only if it is convenient, and in low-density areas, services can be infrequent and expensive to run. A town where buses run once an hour, for instance, cannot persuade many drivers to leave their cars at home.

In conclusion, public transport is an important way to reduce pollution, but it works best alongside cleaner industry, electric vehicles and good city planning, so I agree only partly with the statement.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Traffic jams and exhaust fumes** — kẹt xe và khói xả
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **a daily problem** — vấn đề hằng ngày
- **the main way to reduce it** — cách chính để giảm nó
- **cut pollution significantly** — giảm ô nhiễm đáng kể
- **one of several measures** — một trong nhiều biện pháp
- **far less pollution per passenger** — ô nhiễm trên mỗi hành khách ít hơn nhiều
- **replaces dozens of cars** — thay thế hàng chục ô tô
- **exhaust fumes** — khói thải
- **congestion** — tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **the space needed for roads** — diện tích cần cho đường
- **frequent, reliable and affordable services** — dịch vụ thường xuyên, đáng tin và giá phải chăng
- **fewer private cars on the road** — ít ô tô cá nhân trên đường
- **cuts their share of emissions** — giảm phần khí thải của họ
- **saves time and money** — tiết kiệm thời gian và tiền
- **Much pollution comes from factories, power stations and heating** — phần lớn ô nhiễm đến từ nhà máy, nhà máy điện và sưởi ấm
- **remove tailpipe emissions** — loại bỏ khí thải từ ống xả
- **better urban planning** — quy hoạch đô thị tốt hơn
- **reduces the distances that people need to travel** — giảm quãng đường người ta phải đi
- **low-density areas** — khu dân cư thưa
- **expensive to run** — tốn kém để vận hành
- **leave their cars at home** — để xe ở nhà

#100 Extent · 272 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should corporations be responsible for environmental damage? Give reasons for your answer.

Large companies produce much of the world's pollution and waste, and I largely agree that they should be held responsible for the damage they cause, although governments and consumers also have a part to play.

To begin with, polluters should pay for the damage they cause. When a factory releases waste into a river and the cost of the clean-up falls on taxpayers, the company profits while the public pays, which is unfair. Fines, clean-up charges and taxes make firms include environmental costs in their prices, and this gives them a reason to adopt cleaner methods. Corporations that profit from an activity should bear the cost of its damage, and those with large budgets can usually afford to do so. A chemical company that knows it will pay for any spill, for example, will invest more in safety, because prevention becomes cheaper than compensation. Public pressure also matters, since customers increasingly avoid brands that are linked to pollution.

Furthermore, companies have the knowledge and resources to find solutions. They control their own production, choose their materials and design their packaging, so changes at this level affect millions of products at once, which individual shoppers cannot achieve. However, corporations are not solely to blame. Consumers demand cheap goods, and governments must set clear rules so that responsible firms are not undercut by careless ones. Responsibility should therefore be shared, with businesses carrying the largest part, and with independent inspection to make sure that promises are kept.

In conclusion, corporations should be responsible for environmental damage to a large extent, because they cause it and profit from it, provided that governments enforce fair rules.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **produce much of the world's pollution and waste** — tạo ra phần lớn ô nhiễm và rác của thế giới
- **held responsible for the damage they cause** — chịu trách nhiệm về thiệt hại họ gây ra
- **have a part to play** — có vai trò phải đóng
- **polluters should pay** — bên gây ô nhiễm nên trả tiền
- **releases waste into a river** — xả chất thải ra sông
- **the cost of the clean-up falls on taxpayers** — chi phí dọn dẹp rơi vào người đóng thuế
- **the company profits while the public pays** — công ty hưởng lợi còn công chúng trả giá
- **clean-up charges** — phí dọn dẹp
- **include environmental costs in their prices** — đưa chi phí môi trường vào giá
- **adopt cleaner methods** — áp dụng phương pháp sạch hơn
- **bear the cost of its damage** — gánh chi phí thiệt hại của nó
- **large budgets** — ngân sách lớn
- **prevention becomes cheaper than compensation** — phòng ngừa rẻ hơn bồi thường
- **the knowledge and resources** — kiến thức và nguồn lực
- **choose their materials** — chọn vật liệu
- **design their packaging** — thiết kế bao bì
- **millions of products at once** — hàng triệu sản phẩm cùng lúc
- **solely to blame** — chỉ riêng họ đáng trách
- **undercut by careless ones** — bị doanh nghiệp cẩu thả cạnh tranh giá
- **independent inspection** — kiểm tra độc lập
- **environmental damage** — thiệt hại môi trường
- **enforce fair rules** — thực thi quy tắc công bằng

#133 Extent · 285 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think renewable energy will replace fossil fuels in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

With fossil fuels still supplying most of the world's energy, many people ask how far renewable sources can replace them in the next twenty years. I believe that they will replace fossil fuels only in part: renewables are likely to dominate electricity generation, but oil and gas will remain in heavy industry and transport.

To begin with, there are strong reasons for a rapid shift in electricity. Solar and wind power are already cheaper than coal in many places, they release almost no greenhouse gases, and governments are setting targets to cut emissions. As costs fall and batteries improve, power companies will keep building clean capacity instead of new coal stations. A country that closes its last coal plants and builds wind farms off its coast, for example, can supply a large share of its electricity from renewables within twenty years.

However, replacing fossil fuels completely is far more difficult. Steel, cement, aviation and shipping need very high temperatures or fuels that are dense and light, and electricity cannot yet do these jobs at a reasonable price. In addition, the sun does not always shine and the wind does not always blow, so grids need large amounts of storage and backup power. Many developing countries also depend on cheap coal and oil to grow their economies, and power stations and pipelines built today will operate for decades. These factors mean that change will be uneven across regions and sectors. A factory that makes steel, for instance, cannot switch to wind power in a few years.

In conclusion, renewable energy will replace fossil fuels to a considerable but incomplete extent over the next twenty years, mainly in electricity, while heavy industry and long-distance transport lag behind.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **supplying most of the world's energy** — cung cấp phần lớn năng lượng thế giới
- **replace them** — thay thế chúng
- **only in part** — chỉ một phần
- **dominate electricity generation** — thống trị sản xuất điện
- **heavy industry and transport** — công nghiệp nặng và giao thông
- **a rapid shift** — sự chuyển dịch nhanh
- **cheaper than coal** — rẻ hơn than
- **release almost no greenhouse gases** — thải gần như không khí nhà kính
- **setting targets to cut emissions** — đặt mục tiêu cắt giảm khí thải
- **clean capacity** — công suất sạch
- **closes its last coal plants** — đóng nhà máy than cuối cùng
- **wind farms off its coast** — trang trại gió ngoài khơi
- **replacing fossil fuels completely** — thay thế hoàn toàn nhiên liệu hoá thạch
- **very high temperatures** — nhiệt độ rất cao
- **dense and light** — đậm đặc năng lượng mà nhẹ
- **at a reasonable price** — với giá hợp lý
- **large amounts of storage and backup power** — nhiều kho lưu trữ và điện dự phòng
- **grow their economies** — phát triển kinh tế
- **power stations** — nhà máy điện
- **operate for decades** — hoạt động hàng chục năm
- **uneven across regions and sectors** — không đồng đều giữa các vùng và ngành
- **lag behind** — tụt lại phía sau

#240 Extent · 271 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should animal welfare laws be strengthened? Give reasons for your answer.

Animals are kept on farms, in zoos, in laboratories and in homes, and some people argue that the laws protecting them should be stronger. I largely agree, since animals can feel pain and fear, although laws must also take account of human needs.

To begin with, animals can feel pain and fear, so they deserve legal protection. Weak laws allow cruelty on farms, in circuses and in laboratories, whereas strong laws set minimum standards of care and penalties for those who break them. In some places, for example, hens may be kept in tiny cages for their entire lives, and a law that bans such cages forces producers to give animals room to move. Without legal limits, businesses that want to cut costs may be tempted to ignore suffering, and honest producers are undercut by careless ones.

Furthermore, clear rules reflect the values of a modern society. Most people agree that causing needless suffering is wrong, yet individuals cannot inspect farms or laboratories themselves, so only inspectors acting under strict laws can ensure that standards are kept. Better conditions can also lead to healthier animals and safer food. However, the laws must be realistic. Farmers who face higher costs may need time and financial support to adapt, and some research that depends on animals may save human lives, so such work should be allowed under strict supervision. Strong laws should therefore protect animals without ignoring the needs of people who depend on them.

In conclusion, animal welfare laws should be strengthened to a large extent, because animals can suffer and weak rules allow cruelty, provided that the changes are introduced fairly.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **laws protecting them should be stronger** — luật bảo vệ chúng nên mạnh hơn
- **feel pain and fear** — cảm nhận đau đớn và sợ hãi
- **take account of human needs** — tính đến nhu cầu của con người
- **deserve legal protection** — xứng đáng được pháp luật bảo vệ
- **allow cruelty on farms** — cho phép sự tàn ác ở trang trại
- **minimum standards of care** — tiêu chuẩn chăm sóc tối thiểu
- **penalties for those who break them** — hình phạt cho người vi phạm
- **tiny cages** — những chiếc lồng nhỏ xíu
- **room to move** — chỗ để di chuyển
- **cut costs** — cắt giảm chi phí
- **ignore suffering** — phớt lờ nỗi đau
- **undercut by careless ones** — bị doanh nghiệp cẩu thả cạnh tranh giá
- **reflect the values of a modern society** — phản ánh giá trị của xã hội hiện đại
- **needless suffering** — đau khổ không cần thiết
- **inspectors acting under strict laws** — thanh tra hành động theo luật nghiêm
- **healthier animals and safer food** — động vật khoẻ hơn và thực phẩm an toàn hơn
- **time and financial support to adapt** — thời gian và hỗ trợ tài chính để thích nghi
- **strict supervision** — giám sát nghiêm ngặt
- **depend on them** — phụ thuộc vào chúng
- **introduced fairly** — được áp dụng công bằng

#273 Extent · 279 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think renewable energy technology will become cheaper in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Solar panels, wind turbines and batteries are becoming common, and I believe that renewable energy technology will become considerably cheaper over the next twenty years, although the pace may slow in some areas.

First and foremost, the main drivers of falling prices are likely to continue. As manufacturers build larger factories and produce more equipment, each panel or turbine costs less to make, and engineers keep finding ways to turn more sunlight and wind into electricity from the same machine. Competition between companies, especially in Asia, also pushes prices down. As a result, clean power that once needed subsidies can now compete with coal and gas in many places. A household that fits solar panels today, for example, pays much less than a neighbour did a decade ago, and this experience encourages other families to follow.

In addition, storage and grid technology are improving. Batteries have become cheaper as demand for electric vehicles has increased, which will lower the cost of keeping renewable power available at night. Better control systems will also reduce waste by matching supply with demand. However, costs will not fall in every area. Raw materials such as lithium and copper may become more expensive if mining cannot keep pace with demand, and higher interest rates make large projects costlier to finance. Connecting remote wind farms to cities also requires new power lines, which are expensive and slow to build. Prices may therefore fall more slowly than they did in the past.

In conclusion, renewable technology is likely to become cheaper to a large extent because of larger-scale production, competition and better storage, although material costs and grid investment could limit the speed of the decline.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **becoming common** — trở nên phổ biến
- **considerably cheaper** — rẻ hơn đáng kể
- **the pace may slow** — tốc độ có thể chậm lại
- **the main drivers of falling prices** — động lực chính khiến giá giảm
- **build larger factories** — xây nhà máy lớn hơn
- **costs less to make** — tốn ít chi phí sản xuất hơn
- **turn more sunlight and wind into electricity** — biến nhiều ánh nắng và gió hơn thành điện
- **Competition between companies** — sự cạnh tranh giữa các công ty
- **pushes prices down** — đẩy giá xuống
- **clean power** — điện sạch
- **needed subsidies** — cần trợ cấp
- **compete with coal and gas** — cạnh tranh với than và khí
- **demand for electric vehicles** — nhu cầu xe điện
- **keeping renewable power available at night** — duy trì điện tái tạo vào ban đêm
- **Better control systems** — hệ thống điều khiển tốt hơn
- **reduce waste** — giảm rác thải
- **keep pace with demand** — theo kịp nhu cầu
- **costlier to finance** — tốn kém hơn để tài trợ
- **remote wind farms** — trang trại gió ở xa
- **new power lines** — đường dây điện mới
- **limit the speed of the decline** — hạn chế tốc độ giảm

#280 Extent · 273 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should product labelling include environmental impact information? Give reasons for your answer.

Shoppers are surrounded by information on packaging, from calories to country of origin, but very little of it tells them how a product affects the planet. I largely agree that product labelling should include environmental impact information, since it helps shoppers to choose better, although the system must be simple.

To begin with, environmental impact labels help shoppers to compare products. A simple rating for carbon emissions, water use or recyclability lets buyers choose better options and puts pressure on producers to improve. At present, buyers who want to reduce their impact often have to rely on advertising, which may be misleading. A shopper choosing between two similar bags of rice, for example, cannot tell which one involved more transport or more water unless the label says so. Clear information also helps to expose exaggerated green claims, which protects honest companies.

Furthermore, labels can change the market. When companies know that their ratings will be visible, they have a reason to reduce emissions and packaging, and those that perform well can use the label as a selling point. This is similar to the energy ratings on electrical appliances, which have encouraged manufacturers to make more efficient products. However, complicated or inconsistent labels may confuse shoppers and add costs, especially for small firms, and measuring the exact impact of every product is difficult. Governments should therefore require one clear, standard scheme, such as a colour scale, with independent checking and support for small businesses.

In conclusion, product labels should include environmental impact information to a large extent, because it supports informed choices and encourages better production, provided that the scheme is simple and reliable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **surrounded by information** — bị bao quanh bởi thông tin
- **affects the planet** — ảnh hưởng đến hành tinh
- **environmental impact information** — thông tin về tác động môi trường
- **environmental impact** — tác động môi trường
- **help shoppers to compare products** — giúp người mua so sánh sản phẩm
- **a simple rating** — điểm xếp hạng đơn giản
- **carbon emissions, water use or recyclability** — khí thải carbon, lượng nước dùng hoặc khả năng tái chế
- **puts pressure on producers to improve** — gây áp lực để nhà sản xuất cải thiện
- **rely on advertising** — dựa vào quảng cáo
- **misleading** — gây hiểu lầm
- **involved more transport or more water** — cần nhiều vận chuyển hoặc nước hơn
- **expose exaggerated green claims** — vạch trần tuyên bố xanh phóng đại
- **protects honest companies** — bảo vệ doanh nghiệp trung thực
- **change the market** — thay đổi thị trường
- **use the label as a selling point** — dùng nhãn làm điểm bán hàng
- **energy ratings on electrical appliances** — xếp hạng năng lượng trên thiết bị điện
- **complicated or inconsistent labels** — nhãn phức tạp hoặc thiếu nhất quán
- **confuse shoppers** — làm người mua bối rối
- **the exact impact of every product** — tác động chính xác của mọi sản phẩm
- **one clear, standard scheme** — một chương trình chuẩn và rõ ràng
- **independent checking** — kiểm tra độc lập
- **informed choices** — lựa chọn có thông tin

#332 Extent · 276 từ · AI 8.0

Some argue that strict environmental controls limit economic growth. To what extent do you agree?

Some people claim that strict environmental controls limit economic growth. I agree only to a limited extent, since controls can raise costs in the short term, but they also protect the resources and health on which growth depends.

It is true that strict controls can raise costs for businesses and slow short-term growth. Factories must install cleaner equipment, and firms may respond by raising prices or cutting jobs, which matters most in poorer countries where growth is needed to lift people out of poverty. A small manufacturer that must buy expensive filters, for example, may find it hard to compete with a foreign rival that faces no such rule, and workers can lose their jobs as a result. These concerns should be taken seriously and should not be dismissed as mere excuses.

However, ignoring the environment is expensive in the long run. Floods, droughts and polluted air damage crops, homes and health, and the cost of cleaning up afterwards is usually far higher than the cost of preventing the damage. Environmental policy can also create growth, since renewable energy, insulation and recycling employ workers and encourage new technology. A country that leads in electric vehicles, for instance, can sell them abroad as well as improve its own air. Governments can also reduce the burden on business by introducing controls gradually and offering tax relief for clean equipment, so that companies have time to adapt. Many countries already use such tools, which shows that protection and prosperity can be pursued together.

In conclusion, strict environmental controls may slow growth briefly, but I do not accept that they limit it overall, since growth built on damage cannot last.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **limit economic growth** — hạn chế tăng trưởng kinh tế
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **the resources and health** — tài nguyên và sức khoẻ
- **on which growth depends** — thứ mà tăng trưởng dựa vào
- **It is true that** — đúng là
- **raise costs for businesses** — làm tăng chi phí doanh nghiệp
- **slow short-term growth** — làm chậm tăng trưởng ngắn hạn
- **install cleaner equipment** — lắp thiết bị sạch hơn
- **raising prices or cutting jobs** — tăng giá hoặc cắt việc làm
- **lift people out of poverty** — giúp người dân thoát nghèo
- **expensive filters** — bộ lọc đắt tiền
- **compete with a foreign rival** — cạnh tranh với đối thủ nước ngoài
- **faces no such rule** — không bị quy định như vậy
- **lose their jobs as a result** — mất việc vì thế
- **taken seriously** — được xem xét nghiêm túc
- **dismissed as mere excuses** — bị gạt đi như những cái cớ
- **ignoring the environment** — phớt lờ môi trường
- **expensive in the long run** — đắt về lâu dài
- **Floods, droughts and polluted air** — lũ, hạn hán và không khí ô nhiễm
- **cleaning up afterwards** — dọn dẹp sau đó
- **far higher than the cost of preventing the damage** — cao hơn nhiều so với chi phí ngăn thiệt hại
- **encourage new technology** — khuyến khích công nghệ mới
- **leads in electric vehicles** — dẫn đầu về xe điện
- **sell them abroad** — bán ra nước ngoài
- **improve its own air** — cải thiện không khí của chính mình
- **reduce the burden on business** — giảm gánh nặng cho doanh nghiệp
- **introducing controls gradually** — áp dụng kiểm soát dần dần
- **tax relief for clean equipment** — giảm thuế cho thiết bị sạch
- **have time to adapt** — có thời gian thích nghi

- **slow growth briefly** — làm chậm tăng trưởng trong thời gian ngắn
- **limit it overall** — hạn chế nó nói chung
- **growth built on damage cannot last** — tăng trưởng dựa trên tàn phá không bền

#372 Extent · 267 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that shorter product life cycles harm the environment. To what extent do you agree?

Phones, clothes and appliances are replaced more quickly than ever, and some people argue that shorter product life cycles harm the environment. I largely agree, since faster replacement increases resource use and waste, although newer products can sometimes be more efficient.

To begin with, making a new product uses large amounts of energy, water and raw materials. Most of a phone's environmental impact, for example, comes from mining and manufacturing rather than from daily use, so replacing it after two years instead of five increases that impact. When products are designed to be replaced quickly, with sealed batteries or fashionable styles that go out of date, more items are produced and discarded. Electronic waste, which contains harmful substances, is increasing faster than almost any other type of rubbish, and much of it is not recycled.

Furthermore, shorter life cycles encourage a throwaway culture. When goods are cheap and quickly outdated, people see little point in repairing them, so working items are discarded and landfill sites fill up. Admittedly, new models can be more energy efficient, and fast-moving markets may drive innovation and create jobs. For some products, such as refrigerators, replacing a very old model can save energy. However, these gains are usually smaller than the harm caused by constantly manufacturing new goods. Governments could encourage durable design by requiring repairable products, longer warranties and clear information about expected lifespan, so that buyers can choose items that last.

In conclusion, shorter product life cycles harm the environment to a large extent, because they raise resource use and waste, although efficiency gains in some products should be recognised.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **replaced more quickly than ever** — được thay nhanh hơn bao giờ hết
- **shorter product life cycles** — vòng đời sản phẩm ngắn hơn
- **increases resource use and waste** — làm tăng việc dùng tài nguyên và rác thải
- **large amounts of energy, water and raw materials** — lượng lớn năng lượng, nước và nguyên liệu
- **environmental impact** — tác động môi trường
- **mining and manufacturing** — khai thác và sản xuất
- **rather than from daily use** — chứ không phải từ việc dùng hằng ngày
- **sealed batteries** — pin gắn liền
- **fashionable styles that go out of date** — kiểu thời trang lỗi mốt
- **Electronic waste** — rác điện tử
- **harmful substances** — chất độc hại
- **not recycled** — không được tái chế
- **a throwaway culture** — văn hoá vứt bỏ
- **quickly outdated** — nhanh lỗi thời
- **see little point in repairing them** — thấy ít ý nghĩa khi sửa chữa
- **landfill sites fill up** — bãi chôn lấp đầy lên
- **more energy efficient** — tiết kiệm năng lượng hơn
- **drive innovation** — thúc đẩy đổi mới
- **durable design** — thiết kế bền
- **expected lifespan** — tuổi thọ dự kiến

#442 Extent · 284 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent should governments limit single-use packaging? Give reasons for your answer.

Takeaway boxes, wrappers and shopping bags are used for minutes but remain in the environment for years. I largely agree that governments should limit single-use packaging, since voluntary action by companies has not been enough, although the rules must be realistic.

To begin with, only governments can create rules that apply to everyone. If one supermarket reduces packaging while its rivals do not, it may lose customers or face higher costs, so businesses have little reason to act alone. Laws, taxes and fines create a level playing field in which responsible firms are not undercut by careless ones. Limits on unnecessary wrapping and charges for disposable items also change habits at a scale that appeals to individuals cannot reach. A requirement that restaurants use reusable containers for customers who eat in, for example, would remove millions of items from the waste stream and cost very little to administer.

Furthermore, limiting packaging protects the environment and saves public money. Councils spend large sums collecting and processing rubbish, and litter damages rivers, beaches and wildlife. Producers can be required to pay for the waste they create, which encourages them to design simpler, recyclable packaging. However, limits should not go so far that food becomes unsafe or spoils faster, because that would increase food waste. Exceptions for medical products and perishable foods, and transition periods for small firms, would make the rules fair and practical. Governments should also review the results regularly, so that rules can be adjusted if they cause unexpected problems.

In conclusion, governments should limit single-use packaging to a large extent, because voluntary action is not enough and the damage is costly, provided that the rules protect safety and give businesses time to adapt.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Takeaway boxes, wrappers and shopping bags** — hộp mang đi, giấy gói và túi mua sắm
- **remain in the environment for years** — tồn tại trong môi trường nhiều năm
- **limit single-use packaging** — hạn chế bao bì dùng một lần
- **voluntary action by companies** — hành động tự nguyện của doanh nghiệp
- **the rules must be realistic** — quy định phải thực tế
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **lose customers or face higher costs** — mất khách hoặc chịu chi phí cao hơn
- **little reason to act alone** — ít có lý do hành động một mình
- **create a level playing field** — tạo sân chơi bình đẳng
- **undercut by careless ones** — bị doanh nghiệp cẩu thả cạnh tranh giá
- **unnecessary wrapping** — lớp bọc không cần thiết
- **charges for disposable items** — phí đồ dùng một lần
- **at a scale that appeals to individuals cannot reach** — ở quy mô mà lời kêu gọi cá nhân không với tới
- **reusable containers** — hộp dùng lại được
- **eat in** — ăn tại chỗ
- **the waste stream** — dòng rác thải
- **cost very little to administer** — tốn rất ít để quản lý
- **saves public money** — tiết kiệm tiền công
- **collecting and processing rubbish** — thu gom và xử lý rác
- **pay for the waste they create** — trả tiền cho rác họ tạo ra
- **simpler, recyclable packaging** — bao bì đơn giản, tái chế được
- **spoils faster** — hỏng nhanh hơn
- **perishable foods** — thực phẩm dễ hỏng
- **transition periods for small firms** — giai đoạn chuyển tiếp cho doanh nghiệp nhỏ

#452 Extent · 273 từ · AI 8.0

Some argue that stricter animal protection laws benefit society. To what extent do you agree?

Some countries have strict laws against cruelty to animals while others have almost none, and some argue that stricter animal protection laws benefit society as well as animals. I largely agree, although the benefits depend on laws being enforced fairly.

To begin with, stricter animal protection laws benefit society as well as animals. Respect for animals teaches children compassion, and researchers have found links between cruelty to animals and violence towards people, so laws that take cruelty seriously may help to prevent wider harm. Better conditions on farms can also reduce the risk of disease spreading among animals and into the human population, and they improve food safety. A farm that keeps animals in clean, spacious housing, for example, usually needs fewer antibiotics, which helps to slow the spread of drug-resistant infections.

Furthermore, strong laws support the economy in certain areas. Countries with good records on animal welfare attract responsible tourists and consumers who are willing to pay more for ethical products, and businesses that meet high standards gain a reputation for quality. Clear rules also create a level playing field, so that careful producers are not undercut by careless ones. However, stricter laws can raise costs for farmers and small businesses, and enforcement requires trained inspectors, which governments must fund. Support, advice and transition periods can reduce the burden on producers. If these conditions are met, the gains for society, in health, values and trade, clearly outweigh the costs.

In conclusion, stricter animal protection laws benefit society to a large extent, since they promote compassion, safer food and fair competition, provided that they are enforced fairly and supported by help for producers.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **strict laws against cruelty to animals** — luật nghiêm chống tàn ác với động vật
- **stricter animal protection laws** — luật bảo vệ động vật nghiêm hơn
- **benefit society as well as animals** — có lợi cho xã hội cũng như động vật
- **enforced fairly** — được thực thi công bằng
- **teaches children compassion** — dạy trẻ lòng nhân ái
- **links between cruelty to animals and violence towards people** — mối liên hệ giữa tàn ác với động vật và bạo lực với con người
- **take cruelty seriously** — xem trọng sự tàn ác
- **prevent wider harm** — ngăn tác hại rộng hơn
- **disease spreading among animals** — dịch bệnh lan giữa động vật
- **improve food safety** — cải thiện an toàn thực phẩm
- **clean, spacious housing** — chuồng trại sạch và rộng rãi
- **fewer antibiotics** — ít kháng sinh hơn
- **drug-resistant infections** — nhiễm trùng kháng thuốc
- **responsible tourists** — du khách có trách nhiệm
- **willing to pay more** — sẵn sàng trả nhiều hơn
- **ethical products** — sản phẩm có đạo đức
- **gain a reputation for quality** — có tiếng về chất lượng
- **create a level playing field** — tạo sân chơi bình đẳng
- **undercut by careless ones** — bị doanh nghiệp cẩu thả cạnh tranh giá
- **raise costs for farmers and small businesses** — làm tăng chi phí cho nông dân và doanh nghiệp nhỏ
- **trained inspectors** — thanh tra được đào tạo
- **transition periods** — giai đoạn chuyển tiếp
- **clearly outweigh** — rõ ràng vượt trội hơn

#482 Extent · 277 từ · AI 7.0

To what extent should food origin be labelled on products? Give reasons for your answer.

Shoppers today buy food that has often travelled thousands of kilometres, and many of them have no idea where it was grown. I largely agree that food origin should be labelled on products, since labels help shoppers to make informed choices, although the rules should not be too costly.

To begin with, labels showing where food comes from help shoppers to make informed choices. Buyers can support local farmers, avoid products linked to poor safety records or very long transport, and decide whether they are willing to pay more for particular regions. If a problem such as contamination occurs, a clear origin also makes it easier to trace the source and withdraw the product quickly. A shopper who reads that apples were grown in a nearby region, for example, may choose them over apples flown from another continent, which reduces transport emissions.

Furthermore, labelling gives producers a reason to meet higher standards. When customers can see the origin, farmers and companies are more careful about quality and honesty, because their reputation is visible. It also protects consumers from misleading claims, such as a product described as local when only the packaging was done nearby. However, there are costs. Small producers may find complicated labelling expensive, and origin does not always indicate quality, since good and bad products exist in every country. Rules should therefore be simple and consistent, and phased in with support for small businesses. If the information is easy to read, more people will actually use it when they shop.

In conclusion, food origin should be labelled to a large extent, because it improves choice and accountability, provided that the rules are clear and affordable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **has often travelled thousands of kilometres** — thường đã đi hàng nghìn km
- **food origin should be labelled** — nguồn gốc thực phẩm nên được ghi nhãn
- **informed choices** — lựa chọn có thông tin
- **not be too costly** — không quá tốn kém
- **Labels showing where food comes from** — nhãn ghi rõ thực phẩm đến từ đâu
- **support local farmers** — ủng hộ nông dân địa phương
- **poor safety records** — tiền sử an toàn kém
- **very long transport** — vận chuyển quá xa
- **willing to pay more** — sẵn sàng trả nhiều hơn
- **contamination** — sự nhiễm bẩn
- **trace the source** — truy ra nguồn
- **withdraw the product quickly** — thu hồi sản phẩm nhanh
- **flown from another continent** — vận chuyển bằng máy bay từ châu lục khác
- **transport emissions** — khí thải từ vận chuyển
- **meet higher standards** — đạt chuẩn cao hơn
- **their reputation is visible** — danh tiếng của họ được thấy rõ
- **misleading claims** — tuyên bố gây hiểu lầm
- **complicated labelling** — việc dán nhãn phức tạp
- **does not always indicate quality** — không phải lúc nào cũng cho biết chất lượng
- **simple and consistent** — đơn giản và nhất quán
- **improves choice and accountability** — cải thiện lựa chọn và trách nhiệm giải trình

Agree / Disagree

#47 Agree / Disagree · 282 từ · AI 8.0

Many people say that single-use plastics should be banned. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Plastic cups, bags and straws are used for a few minutes and then thrown away, and many people say that single-use plastics should be banned. I agree with this view, since these items cause lasting damage to nature and there are practical alternatives for almost all of them.

To begin with, plastic persists in the environment for centuries. Single-use items rarely decompose; instead they break into tiny pieces called microplastics, which are found in rivers, soil and even the food that people eat. Marine animals such as turtles and seabirds swallow plastic or become trapped in it, and cleaning oceans afterwards is extremely difficult and costly. Because these products are used only once, the scale of the problem grows every year. A beach covered with bottles and bags, for example, harms wildlife and also discourages tourists, which damages the local economy.

Furthermore, bans work when alternatives exist, and for most single-use plastics they do. Paper bags, cloth shopping bags, metal straws and reusable bottles perform the same function and can be used many times. When shops in several countries introduced a small charge for plastic bags, for instance, their use fell sharply, which shows that people adapt quickly once the habit is changed. Admittedly, a ban may raise costs for some businesses and could be difficult to enforce among small sellers, but this problem can be eased by giving firms time to switch and by supporting cheaper substitutes. Over time, the new habits become normal and the benefits for rivers, beaches and wildlife become clear.

In conclusion, I agree that single-use plastics should be banned, because they cause lasting harm and sensible alternatives are available, provided that the ban is introduced gradually.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Plastic cups, bags and straws** — cốc, túi và ống hút nhựa
- **thrown away** — bị vứt đi
- **single-use plastics should be banned** — nhựa dùng một lần nên bị cấm
- **lasting damage to nature** — thiệt hại lâu dài với thiên nhiên
- **practical alternatives** — phương án thay thế thiết thực
- **persists in the environment for centuries** — tồn tại hàng thế kỷ trong môi trường
- **rarely decompose** — hiếm khi phân huỷ
- **tiny pieces called microplastics** — những mảnh nhỏ gọi là vi nhựa
- **the food that people eat** — thức ăn con người ăn
- **swallow plastic or become trapped in it** — nuốt nhựa hoặc bị mắc kẹt trong đó
- **cleaning oceans afterwards** — dọn đại dương sau đó
- **the scale of the problem grows every year** — quy mô vấn đề tăng lên mỗi năm
- **harms wildlife** — gây hại động vật hoang dã
- **discourages tourists** — làm du khách nản lòng
- **perform the same function** — thực hiện cùng chức năng
- **can be used many times** — có thể dùng nhiều lần
- **a small charge for plastic bags** — khoản phí nhỏ cho túi nhựa
- **fell sharply** — giảm mạnh
- **adapt quickly** — thích nghi nhanh
- **introduced gradually** — được áp dụng dần dần

#124 Agree / Disagree · 274 từ · AI 7.5

Many feel that food packaging is too wasteful. Do you agree? Explain your view.

Fruit sealed in plastic trays, snacks wrapped twice and online parcels filled with extra padding are familiar sights, and many people feel that food packaging is too wasteful. I largely agree, although some packaging does protect food.

To begin with, much food packaging is excessive. Products are often wrapped in several layers, such as a box, a plastic tray and a film, when one layer would be enough, and large boxes are used for small items. Much packaging exists for marketing rather than protection, and most of this material is thrown away within minutes. A large share cannot be recycled because it mixes different plastics. A cucumber wrapped in plastic, for example, already has its own natural skin, so the extra layer adds waste without adding protection. Over a year, such small choices add up to huge quantities of rubbish.

Furthermore, wasteful packaging creates avoidable pollution and costs. Producing and transporting packaging uses energy and raw materials, and litter from takeaway containers pollutes streets and waterways. Consumers pay for the packaging in the price, and councils pay to collect it. However, some packaging is necessary. It protects food from damage, keeps it hygienic and can extend its shelf life, which reduces food waste. Companies should therefore keep protective packaging but cut the unnecessary extras, and use materials that are easier to recycle or reuse. Refill stations and loose products, for instance, allow shoppers to buy only what they need in their own containers, which saves both money and materials.

In conclusion, I largely agree that food packaging is too wasteful, since much of it is unnecessary, although essential protection for food should be kept.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Fruit sealed in plastic trays** — hoa quả đóng trong khay nhựa
- **wrapped twice** — bọc hai lần
- **extra padding** — vật liệu độn thừa
- **too wasteful** — quá lãng phí
- **much food packaging is excessive** — nhiều bao bì thực phẩm là thừa
- **several layers** — nhiều lớp
- **when one layer would be enough** — khi một lớp là đủ
- **exists for marketing rather than protection** — tồn tại vì tiếp thị chứ không để bảo vệ
- **thrown away within minutes** — bị vứt trong vài phút
- **cannot be recycled** — không thể tái chế
- **mixes different plastics** — trộn nhiều loại nhựa
- **its own natural skin** — lớp vỏ tự nhiên của nó
- **add up to huge quantities of rubbish** — cộng lại thành lượng rác khổng lồ
- **avoidable pollution and costs** — ô nhiễm và chi phí có thể tránh
- **uses energy and raw materials** — tốn năng lượng và nguyên liệu
- **pollutes streets and waterways** — làm ô nhiễm đường phố và đường nước
- **extend its shelf life** — kéo dài hạn sử dụng
- **unnecessary extras** — phần thừa không cần thiết
- **easier to recycle** — dễ tái chế hơn
- **Refill stations** — điểm nạp lại
- **in their own containers** — trong hộp của chính họ

#207 Agree / Disagree · 277 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that public gardens should be protected from development. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

As cities grow, public gardens are sometimes sold for housing or shops, and many people say that they should be protected from development. I agree with this view, since gardens give city residents health, shade and a place to meet that cannot easily be replaced.

To begin with, public gardens give city residents health, shade and a place to meet. They cool the air in summer, absorb dust and pollution, shelter birds and insects and offer free space to rest, exercise and play. For people who live in flats without a garden, these places are often the only contact with nature. A small garden in a crowded district, for example, may be used every day by older residents, parents with young children and office workers on their lunch break. Studies of many cities suggest that access to green space improves physical and mental health.

Furthermore, once a garden has been built over, it is almost impossible to replace. New trees need decades to mature, and the history and community life of the site are lost for good. Housing, by contrast, can usually be built on empty or abandoned sites, or on land that has already been developed, so protecting gardens does not mean stopping growth. Admittedly, cities need more homes and economic activity, and some gardens may be poorly used or badly kept. In such cases, authorities should improve them instead of selling them, and any development that does take place should be limited and balanced by new green space elsewhere.

In conclusion, I agree that public gardens should be protected from development, because they are valuable and irreplaceable, although well-planned building on other sites should continue.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public gardens** — vườn công cộng
- **sold for housing or shops** — bị bán để xây nhà hoặc cửa hàng
- **protected from development** — được bảo vệ khỏi phát triển
- **health, shade and a place to meet** — sức khoẻ, bóng mát và nơi gặp gỡ
- **cannot easily be replaced** — không dễ thay thế
- **cool the air in summer** — làm mát không khí mùa hè
- **absorb dust and pollution** — hấp thụ bụi và ô nhiễm
- **shelter birds and insects** — che chở chim và côn trùng
- **free space to rest, exercise and play** — không gian miễn phí để nghỉ, tập thể dục và chơi
- **contact with nature** — sự tiếp xúc với thiên nhiên
- **a crowded district** — khu phố đông đúc
- **on their lunch break** — trong giờ nghỉ trưa
- **access to green space** — tiếp cận không gian xanh
- **physical and mental health** — sức khoẻ thể chất và tinh thần
- **built over** — bị xây lên
- **almost impossible to replace** — gần như không thể thay thế
- **lost for good** — mất vĩnh viễn
- **empty or abandoned sites** — khu đất trống hoặc bỏ hoang
- **poorly used or badly kept** — ít được dùng hoặc quản lý kém
- **green space** — không gian xanh
- **irreplaceable** — không thể thay thế

#247 Agree / Disagree · 285 từ · AI 8.0

Many people say that human activity causes climate change. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Many people say that human activity causes climate change. I agree with this view, since the evidence links rising temperatures to emissions from industry and transport, and the speed of the change is hard to explain by natural cycles alone.

To begin with, scientific evidence links the recent rise in temperatures to human activity. Burning coal, oil and gas and clearing forests release gases that trap heat in the atmosphere, and temperatures have risen alongside emissions since the industrial era began. Natural cycles, such as volcanic activity and changes in the sun's output, operate over thousands of years, so they cannot account for such rapid warming. A greenhouse works in a similar way, which is why these gases are said to warm the planet.

Furthermore, the effects of human activity can be seen in everyday life. Cities full of cars and factories produce far more emissions than rural areas, and the loss of forests removes the trees that would absorb carbon dioxide. Rising sea levels, melting glaciers and more extreme weather have become more frequent in recent decades, which fits the pattern expected from added greenhouse gases. Admittedly, natural factors still influence the climate, but this is not the same as saying that people are not responsible. Recognising human causes is also useful, because it means that people can change the outcome by cutting emissions, protecting forests and investing in clean energy. This practical point matters, since it turns a worrying fact into a reason for action. It also shows that the problem, although serious, is not beyond human control.

In conclusion, I agree that human activity causes climate change, because the evidence is strong and the speed of the warming points to human sources.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **human activity causes climate change** — hoạt động con người gây biến đổi khí hậu
- **emissions from industry and transport** — khí thải từ công nghiệp và giao thông
- **hard to explain by natural cycles alone** — khó giải thích chỉ bằng chu kỳ tự nhiên
- **scientific evidence** — bằng chứng khoa học
- **Burning coal, oil and gas** — đốt than, dầu và khí
- **clearing forests** — phá rừng
- **trap heat** — giữ nhiệt
- **in the atmosphere** — trong khí quyển
- **alongside emissions** — song song với khí thải
- **the industrial era** — kỷ nguyên công nghiệp
- **changes in the sun's output** — thay đổi năng lượng của mặt trời
- **account for such rapid warming** — giải thích sự nóng lên nhanh như vậy
- **warm the planet** — làm nóng hành tinh
- **seen in everyday life** — thấy được trong đời sống hằng ngày
- **produce far more emissions than rural areas** — thải nhiều hơn vùng nông thôn
- **the loss of forests** — việc mất rừng
- **absorb carbon dioxide** — hấp thụ khí carbon dioxide
- **Rising sea levels** — mực nước biển dâng
- **melting glaciers** — sông băng tan chảy
- **more extreme weather** — thời tiết cực đoan hơn
- **fits the pattern expected from** — phù hợp với quy luật dự kiến từ
- **added greenhouse gases** — khí nhà kính bổ sung
- **natural factors** — yếu tố tự nhiên
- **not responsible** — không có trách nhiệm
- **change the outcome** — thay đổi kết cục
- **protecting forests** — bảo vệ rừng
- **investing in clean energy** — đầu tư vào năng lượng sạch

#287 Agree / Disagree · 281 từ · AI 8.0

Many people say that renewable energy investments create jobs. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Many governments now spend large sums on wind, solar and other clean power, and people say that this investment creates jobs. I largely agree with this view, since renewable projects need many workers at every stage, although some jobs in older industries may disappear.

To begin with, building and running renewable energy requires a wide range of workers. Factories make panels, turbine blades and batteries, construction crews build wind farms and solar parks, electricians install equipment on roofs and in substations, and technicians inspect and repair machines for decades afterwards. Many of these jobs are located in local communities rather than in distant cities, which spreads the benefit widely. A town that hosts a new wind farm, for example, may gain hundreds of jobs during construction and a smaller number of permanent posts for maintenance.

Furthermore, clean energy encourages new technology and related businesses. Companies that design software for smart grids, produce insulation or develop better batteries employ engineers and researchers, and a country that leads in these fields can sell its products abroad. Investment in this area also supports construction and transport firms that supply the projects. However, the picture is not entirely positive. Coal mines and power stations may close, and workers there cannot always move into new roles without help, because the skills required are different. Governments should therefore provide retraining and support for the regions affected, so that the gains are shared fairly. This support is not only fair but also practical, since a skilled workforce is needed to build the new industry.

In conclusion, I agree that renewable energy investments create jobs, especially in manufacturing, installation and maintenance, provided that workers in declining industries receive support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **spend large sums on** — chi những khoản lớn cho
- **clean power** — điện sạch
- **at every stage** — ở mọi giai đoạn
- **jobs in older industries** — việc làm ở ngành cũ
- **a wide range of workers** — nhiều loại lao động
- **turbine blades** — cánh tuabin
- **construction crews** — đội thi công
- **solar parks** — khu điện mặt trời
- **install equipment on roofs** — lắp thiết bị trên mái nhà
- **substations** — trạm biến áp
- **technicians inspect and repair machines** — kỹ thuật viên kiểm tra và sửa máy
- **located in local communities** — nằm trong cộng đồng địa phương
- **spreads the benefit widely** — lan toả lợi ích rộng rãi
- **a smaller number of permanent posts** — số ít vị trí lâu dài
- **software for smart grids** — phần mềm cho lưới điện thông minh
- **sell its products abroad** — bán sản phẩm ra nước ngoài
- **Coal mines and power stations may close** — mỏ than và nhà máy điện có thể đóng cửa
- **move into new roles** — chuyển sang vai trò mới
- **retraining** — đào tạo lại
- **the gains are shared fairly** — lợi ích được chia sẻ công bằng
- **installation and maintenance** — lắp đặt và bảo trì

#304 Agree / Disagree · 271 từ · AI 8.0

Many people think that wildlife conservation has improved people's lives. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Wildlife conservation is often seen as a luxury that benefits animals more than people. I agree that it has improved people's lives, since healthy ecosystems provide practical services and many communities earn a living from protected nature.

To begin with, wildlife conservation improves people's lives in practical ways. Healthy ecosystems pollinate crops, clean water and reduce floods, and these services would cost enormous sums to replace artificially. Bees that pollinate fruit trees, for example, help farmers to harvest more apples and almonds without any extra cost. Forests and wetlands protected for wildlife also store water and reduce the damage caused by storms. In addition, wild plants and animals provide the basis for new medicines, so losing a species may mean losing a future treatment.

Furthermore, conservation creates jobs and income. Nature tourism brings visitors to national parks and reserves, and local people work as guides, rangers, drivers and hotel staff. When communities share in these earnings, they have a reason to protect wildlife instead of hunting or clearing the land. Contact with nature also benefits mental health and offers children a chance to learn about the living world. Admittedly, conservation sometimes restricts land use and can cause conflict, as when elephants damage crops, but compensation schemes and community involvement can reduce these problems. Overall, the benefits to people, in food, water, income and wellbeing, are considerable and far-reaching. Protecting a forest, for instance, also means protecting the rivers that supply nearby towns.

In conclusion, I agree that wildlife conservation has improved people's lives, because it supports essential natural services and provides income, provided that local communities share fairly in the gains.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **wildlife conservation** — bảo tồn động vật hoang dã
- **a luxury that benefits animals more than people** — điều xa xỉ mang lại lợi ích cho động vật hơn con người
- **improved people's lives** — cải thiện cuộc sống con người
- **healthy ecosystems** — hệ sinh thái khoẻ mạnh
- **earn a living from protected nature** — kiếm sống từ thiên nhiên được bảo vệ
- **in practical ways** — theo những cách thiết thực
- **pollinate crops** — thụ phấn cho cây trồng
- **clean water and reduce floods** — làm sạch nước và giảm lũ
- **replace artificially** — thay thế bằng nhân tạo
- **without any extra cost** — không tốn thêm chi phí
- **store water** — trữ nước
- **the damage caused by storms** — thiệt hại do bão
- **new medicines** — thuốc mới
- **a future treatment** — một phương pháp điều trị trong tương lai
- **creates jobs and income** — tạo việc làm và thu nhập
- **Nature tourism** — du lịch thiên nhiên
- **guides, rangers, drivers and hotel staff** — hướng dẫn viên, kiểm lâm, tài xế và nhân viên khách sạn
- **share in these earnings** — chia sẻ thu nhập này
- **contact with nature** — sự tiếp xúc với thiên nhiên
- **restricts land use** — hạn chế sử dụng đất
- **compensation schemes** — chương trình bồi thường

#346 Agree / Disagree · 287 từ · AI 7.5

Many feel that product packaging is wasteful and unnecessary. Do you agree? Explain your view.

Many products, from phones to cosmetics, arrive in boxes that are larger than the item and filled with plastic, paper and foam. I agree that much product packaging is wasteful and unnecessary, although some of it has a genuine purpose.

To begin with, a great deal of packaging exists mainly for marketing rather than protection. Attractive boxes, extra layers and oversized containers make products look more valuable, but they are discarded as soon as the item is opened. Online shopping adds more waste, as a small object may be sent in a large box filled with padding. A small bottle of perfume inside a box, a plastic case and a wrapping film, for example, uses far more material than the product needs. When millions of items are sold, this excess becomes a mountain of rubbish that councils must collect and dispose of.

Furthermore, this extra material has real costs for the environment. Making packaging consumes energy, water and raw materials, and much of it ends up in landfill or is burned, because mixed materials are hard to recycle. Larger boxes also take up more space in lorries, so more trips are needed to deliver the same goods. However, some packaging is necessary: fragile items such as glass or electronics need protection, and safe packaging prevents damage that would waste the product itself. The sensible answer is therefore not to abolish packaging but to design it better, using the smallest suitable size and materials that can be recycled. Governments could encourage this through standards and by making producers pay for the waste they create.

In conclusion, I agree that much product packaging is wasteful and unnecessary, but with better design and clear rules the problem can be reduced.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **from phones to cosmetics** — từ điện thoại đến mỹ phẩm
- **larger than the item** — lớn hơn món hàng
- **filled with plastic, paper and foam** — chứa đầy nhựa, giấy và xốp
- **wasteful and unnecessary** — lãng phí và không cần thiết
- **a genuine purpose** — mục đích thực sự
- **a great deal of packaging** — rất nhiều bao bì
- **Attractive boxes** — hộp bắt mắt
- **oversized containers** — hộp quá khổ
- **look more valuable** — trông có giá trị hơn
- **discarded as soon as the item is opened** — bị bỏ ngay khi mở hàng
- **Online shopping adds more waste** — mua sắm trực tuyến thêm nhiều rác
- **uses far more material than the product needs** — dùng nhiều vật liệu hơn sản phẩm cần
- **a mountain of rubbish** — núi rác
- **ends up in landfill or is burned** — kết thúc ở bãi chôn lấp hoặc bị đốt
- **hard to recycle** — khó tái chế
- **take up more space in lorries** — chiếm nhiều chỗ trong xe tải
- **fragile items** — hàng dễ vỡ
- **design it better** — thiết kế tốt hơn
- **the smallest suitable size** — kích cỡ nhỏ nhất phù hợp
- **pay for the waste they create** — trả tiền cho rác họ tạo ra

#357 Agree / Disagree · 270 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe that banning single-use plastics is effective. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Many countries have banned items such as plastic bags, straws and cutlery, and some people believe that these bans are an effective way of dealing with plastic pollution. I largely agree, although a ban works best when it is part of a wider approach.

To begin with, bans change behaviour quickly and reduce litter. When a product is no longer available, people have to use alternatives, and the effect is immediate rather than gradual. Places that have charged for or banned plastic bags generally report that their use falls sharply and that fewer bags are found on beaches and in rivers. A shop that can no longer give out plastic cutlery, for example, will switch to wooden or reusable alternatives, and customers soon accept the change. Bans also send a clear signal that society regards wasteful products as unacceptable, which encourages businesses to invest in better materials.

However, bans are not enough on their own. Some substitutes, such as paper or thick cotton bags, need more energy to produce, so the environmental benefit depends on people reusing them many times. Enforcement can also be weak, particularly among small sellers and markets, and plastic from other sources, such as packaging and fishing nets, continues to pollute. Bans should therefore be combined with deposit schemes, better recycling and public education, and with support for businesses that must change. Without these measures, banned items may simply be replaced by others that cause similar harm.

In conclusion, banning single-use plastics is effective to a large extent in cutting litter quickly, but it needs the support of other measures to deal with the whole problem.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **banned items such as plastic bags, straws and cutlery** — cấm các món như túi, ống hút và dao nĩa nhựa
- **dealing with plastic pollution** — giải quyết ô nhiễm nhựa
- **part of a wider approach** — một phần của cách tiếp cận rộng hơn
- **change behaviour quickly** — thay đổi hành vi nhanh
- **reduce litter** — giảm rác vứt bừa
- **no longer available** — không còn có sẵn
- **immediate rather than gradual** — tức thì thay vì từ từ
- **fewer bags are found on beaches and in rivers** — ít túi hơn được tìm thấy trên bãi biển và sông
- **give out plastic cutlery** — phát dao nĩa nhựa
- **wooden or reusable alternatives** — phương án bằng gỗ hoặc dùng lại được
- **send a clear signal** — gửi tín hiệu rõ ràng
- **regards wasteful products as unacceptable** — coi sản phẩm lãng phí là không chấp nhận được
- **not enough on their own** — không đủ nếu đứng một mình
- **need more energy to produce** — cần nhiều năng lượng hơn để sản xuất
- **depends on people reusing them many times** — phụ thuộc việc dùng lại nhiều lần
- **small sellers and markets** — người bán nhỏ và chợ
- **fishing nets** — lưới đánh cá
- **deposit schemes** — chương trình đặt cọc vỏ chai
- **support for businesses that must change** — hỗ trợ doanh nghiệp phải thay đổi
- **cause similar harm** — gây hại tương tự

#383 Agree / Disagree · 283 từ · AI 7.5

Some people say that recycling should be mandatory. Do you agree or disagree?

Many households still throw recyclable materials into the general bin, and some people say that recycling should be made mandatory. I agree with this view, since voluntary schemes have not achieved high participation, although compulsion must be accompanied by good services.

To begin with, mandatory recycling creates much higher participation. When recycling is optional, many people ignore it because it takes effort and the benefit seems small, so valuable materials end up in landfill. A clear legal requirement, backed by modest fines or by collection rules that refuse mixed rubbish, turns recycling into a normal habit, in the same way that seat belts became normal once they were compulsory. Higher volumes also supply recycling plants with the material they need to operate profitably, which keeps costs down. A district that requires sorting at the kerb, for example, may recycle far more than one that merely asks residents to take part.

Furthermore, a rule shows that society regards waste as a shared responsibility. Without it, careful households bear the effort while others do nothing, which is unfair. However, compulsion works only if people are given the means to comply. Authorities must provide convenient collection, clear instructions and bins of the right size, and they should begin with warnings and education rather than immediate penalties. Rules that are too strict or too complicated may cause resentment and poor sorting, so contaminated loads can end up wasted anyway. Introduced fairly and explained well, mandatory recycling is a sensible step that most communities will accept after a short time.

In conclusion, I agree that recycling should be mandatory, because voluntary action has not been enough, provided that the rules are supported by easy services and sensible enforcement.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **throw recyclable materials into the general bin** — vứt vật liệu tái chế được vào thùng rác chung
- **made mandatory** — được bắt buộc
- **voluntary schemes** — chương trình tự nguyện
- **high participation** — tỷ lệ tham gia cao
- **compulsion** — sự bắt buộc
- **participation** — sự tham gia
- **takes effort** — tốn công sức
- **the benefit seems small** — lợi ích có vẻ nhỏ
- **end up in landfill** — kết thúc ở bãi chôn lấp
- **a clear legal requirement** — yêu cầu pháp lý rõ ràng
- **modest fines** — tiền phạt nhẹ
- **refuse mixed rubbish** — từ chối rác lẫn lộn
- **a normal habit** — thói quen bình thường
- **seat belts** — dây an toàn
- **operate profitably** — hoạt động có lãi
- **keeps costs down** — giữ chi phí thấp
- **regards waste as a shared responsibility** — coi rác thải là trách nhiệm chung
- **bear the effort** — gánh công sức
- **the means to comply** — phương tiện để tuân thủ
- **warnings and education rather than immediate penalties** — cảnh báo và giáo dục thay vì phạt ngay
- **contaminated loads** — mẻ rác bị nhiễm bẩn
- **introduced fairly** — được áp dụng công bằng

#406 Agree / Disagree · 275 từ · AI 7.5

Many feel that fast fashion harms the environment. Do you agree? Explain your view.

Cheap clothes that change with every season are available in almost every high street, and many people feel that fast fashion harms the environment. I agree with this view, since the industry encourages overconsumption and creates large amounts of waste and pollution.

To begin with, fast fashion encourages people to buy more clothes than they need. Cheap, quickly changing styles lead to overproduction, high water and energy use, synthetic fibres that release microplastics, and large amounts of discarded clothing. A cheap dress that is worn twice and then thrown away, for example, wastes the water and energy used to make it. Producing cotton uses a great deal of water, and dyeing fabrics can pollute rivers if factories are poorly regulated. Because clothes are sold at very low prices, shoppers treat them as disposable, and much of what is thrown away ends up in landfill or is burned.

Furthermore, the damage is increased by the speed and scale of the industry. Garments are made far from where they are sold and transported across the world, which adds emissions, and many are poorly made so that they fall apart after a few washes. Admittedly, the fashion industry provides jobs, and affordable clothes are valuable for families on low incomes. However, these benefits do not require such rapid turnover. Consumers can buy fewer, better-made items, choose second-hand clothes and repair what they own, while governments can require companies to take responsibility for waste and for pollution in their supply chains.

In conclusion, I agree that fast fashion harms the environment, because it drives overconsumption and waste, although changes in shopping habits and stronger regulation could reduce the damage.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Cheap clothes that change with every season** — quần áo rẻ thay đổi theo mỗi mùa
- **fast fashion harms the environment** — thời trang nhanh gây hại môi trường
- **encourages overconsumption** — khuyến khích tiêu dùng quá mức
- **buy more clothes than they need** — mua nhiều quần áo hơn cần
- **Cheap, quickly changing styles** — kiểu dáng rẻ và thay đổi nhanh
- **overproduction** — sản xuất thừa
- **high water and energy use** — tiêu tốn nhiều nước và năng lượng
- **synthetic fibres that release microplastics** — sợi tổng hợp thải ra vi nhựa
- **discarded clothing** — quần áo bị vứt bỏ
- **worn twice and then thrown away** — mặc hai lần rồi vứt
- **dyeing fabrics can pollute rivers** — nhuộm vải có thể làm ô nhiễm sông
- **treat them as disposable** — coi chúng như đồ dùng một lần
- **thrown away** — bị vứt đi
- **ends up in landfill or is burned** — kết thúc ở bãi chôn lấp hoặc bị đốt
- **the speed and scale of the industry** — tốc độ và quy mô của ngành
- **transported across the world** — vận chuyển khắp thế giới
- **fall apart after a few washes** — rách sau vài lần giặt
- **affordable clothes** — quần áo giá phải chăng
- **rapid turnover** — vòng quay nhanh
- **second-hand clothes** — quần áo cũ
- **pollution in their supply chains** — ô nhiễm trong chuỗi cung ứng

#429 Agree / Disagree · 272 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that public beaches should be preserved from development. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Beaches are among the most popular public places, but many coastlines are now being lined with hotels, apartments and private clubs. I agree that public beaches should be preserved from development, since they are a shared resource that protects the coast and should stay open to everyone.

To begin with, public beaches should stay open to everyone. Building along the shore privatises access, so that ordinary families are shut out of places that were once free to enjoy. Beaches offer cheap recreation and exercise for people of all incomes, and restricting access creates a divide between those who can afford a sea view and those who cannot. A resort that blocks the path to the water with fences and security guards, for example, turns a public place into a private one. Once access is lost, it is rarely regained.

Furthermore, building on or near the shore damages the natural features that protect people and wildlife. Sand dunes act as barriers against storms and floods, and construction can remove them, speed up erosion and increase the risk to nearby homes. Lights, noise and crowds also disturb nesting birds and turtles. Well-managed beaches keep attracting visitors and income without permanent damage. Admittedly, development brings jobs and tourist spending, and some facilities such as toilets and cafes are useful. However, a limited amount of simple, low-impact building set back from the shore can provide most of these benefits, while keeping the beach itself open and natural.

In conclusion, I agree that public beaches should be preserved from development, because they belong to everyone and protect the coast, although small, carefully planned facilities can be allowed.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **lined with hotels, apartments and private clubs** — chen chúc khách sạn, căn hộ và câu lạc bộ riêng
- **public beaches** — bãi biển công cộng
- **preserved from development** — được bảo tồn khỏi phát triển
- **a shared resource** — tài nguyên chung
- **stay open to everyone** — luôn mở cho mọi người
- **privatises access** — tư nhân hoá lối vào
- **shut out of places that were once free to enjoy** — bị chặn khỏi nơi từng được hưởng miễn phí
- **cheap recreation and exercise** — giải trí và tập luyện giá rẻ
- **people of all incomes** — người thuộc mọi mức thu nhập
- **creates a divide** — tạo ra sự chia rẽ
- **a sea view** — tầm nhìn ra biển
- **blocks the path to the water** — chặn đường ra nước
- **rarely regained** — hiếm khi lấy lại được
- **damages the natural features** — làm hỏng các đặc điểm tự nhiên
- **Sand dunes act as barriers against storms and floods** — đụn cát là rào chắn bão và lũ
- **speed up erosion** — làm xói lở nhanh hơn
- **disturb nesting birds and turtles** — làm phiền chim và rùa làm tổ
- **tourist spending** — chi tiêu của du khách
- **low-impact** — tác động thấp
- **set back from the shore** — lùi xa khỏi bờ biển
- **carefully planned facilities** — tiện ích được quy hoạch cẩn thận

#437 Agree / Disagree · 275 từ · AI 7.5

Some believe that ocean conservation should be a global priority. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Plastic waste, overfishing and rising temperatures are damaging the world's seas, and some people believe that ocean conservation should be a global priority. I largely agree, since the ocean is shared by all countries and supports human life, although other urgent problems must not be neglected.

To begin with, the ocean is a shared resource that no single country can protect alone. Fish stocks, currents and pollution cross borders, so action by one nation can be undone by another. Fishing fleets that empty a region's waters, for example, leave coastal communities in other countries with fewer fish. Only international agreements, shared monitoring and common rules can prevent such harm. A global priority also encourages richer countries to help poorer ones to protect their coastlines.

Furthermore, the sea provides food for billions of people and helps to regulate the climate and produce oxygen. If marine ecosystems collapse, millions of people who depend on fishing and coastal tourism would lose their income and their main source of protein. Healthy oceans also absorb large amounts of carbon dioxide, which slows climate change. However, ocean conservation cannot be the only priority. Governments also face poverty, health care and education, and enforcement across huge areas of open water is difficult. Realistic goals, such as protected zones, catch limits and stronger rules on plastic, together with funding for poorer countries, would make conservation both effective and fair. Success in a few well-chosen areas could encourage other countries to follow.

In conclusion, ocean conservation should be a global priority to a large extent, because the sea is shared and essential for human life, provided that it is balanced with other urgent needs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Plastic waste, overfishing and rising temperatures** — rác nhựa, đánh bắt quá mức và nhiệt độ tăng
- **damaging the world's seas** — làm tổn hại biển của thế giới
- **ocean conservation** — bảo tồn đại dương
- **a global priority** — ưu tiên toàn cầu
- **shared by all countries** — được mọi quốc gia chia sẻ
- **supports human life** — nuôi dưỡng sự sống con người
- **a shared resource** — tài nguyên chung
- **no single country can protect alone** — không quốc gia nào bảo vệ một mình được
- **Fish stocks, currents and pollution cross borders** — đàn cá, dòng hải lưu và ô nhiễm vượt biên giới
- **undone by another** — bị nước khác làm mất tác dụng
- **empty a region's waters** — khai thác cạn vùng biển
- **international agreements** — thoả thuận quốc tế
- **common rules** — quy tắc chung
- **protect their coastlines** — bảo vệ bờ biển của họ
- **regulate the climate and produce oxygen** — điều hoà khí hậu và sản sinh oxy
- **marine ecosystems collapse** — hệ sinh thái biển sụp đổ
- **main source of protein** — nguồn đạm chính
- **absorb large amounts of carbon dioxide** — hấp thụ lượng lớn khí CO2
- **protected zones** — khu bảo vệ
- **catch limits** — hạn ngạch đánh bắt

#446 Agree / Disagree · 282 từ · AI 8.0

Many feel that product warranties should be longer to reduce waste. Do you agree? Explain your view.

A product that breaks just after its guarantee ends is likely to be thrown away, and many people feel that warranties should be longer in order to reduce waste. I agree with this view, since longer warranties encourage better products and make repair more common.

To begin with, longer warranties give manufacturers a reason to build durable goods. If a company must repair or replace its products for five years instead of one, it will use stronger parts and better testing, because failures become costly. Products that last longer mean fewer items are made and discarded, which saves energy, water and raw materials. A washing machine with a ten-year guarantee, for example, is likely to be built to last, and its owner does not need to buy a replacement after two years. Over time, durable design would reduce the pile of broken goods that councils must handle.

Furthermore, longer warranties make repair the normal choice. When a fault is covered, customers return the product for repair instead of throwing it away, and companies develop repair services and supply spare parts. Consumers also benefit, since they spend less on replacements. Admittedly, longer guarantees may raise the initial price, and some firms might try to avoid claims. However, honest firms can recover the cost through lower replacement rates and stronger customer loyalty, and governments can set minimum standards and penalise those who refuse legitimate repairs. Clear rules would protect both buyers and sellers, and would make long-lasting products a selling point instead of a rarity.

In conclusion, I agree that warranties should be longer, because this encourages durable design and repair, which reduces waste, provided that clear rules prevent firms from avoiding their responsibilities.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **just after its guarantee ends** — ngay sau khi hết bảo hành
- **thrown away** — bị vứt đi
- **warranties should be longer** — bảo hành nên dài hơn
- **reduce waste** — giảm rác thải
- **encourage better products** — khuyến khích sản phẩm tốt hơn
- **make repair more common** — làm việc sửa chữa phổ biến hơn
- **build durable goods** — làm hàng hoá bền
- **repair or replace its products** — sửa hoặc thay sản phẩm của mình
- **stronger parts and better testing** — linh kiện chắc hơn và kiểm tra tốt hơn
- **failures become costly** — hỏng hóc trở nên tốn kém
- **fewer items are made and discarded** — ít món hàng được làm ra và vứt bỏ
- **built to last** — được làm để dùng lâu
- **durable design** — thiết kế bền
- **the pile of broken goods** — đống hàng hỏng
- **the normal choice** — lựa chọn bình thường
- **When a fault is covered** — khi lỗi được bảo hành
- **supply spare parts** — cung cấp phụ tùng
- **spend less on replacements** — chi ít hơn cho hàng thay thế
- **raise the initial price** — làm tăng giá ban đầu
- **avoid claims** — né tránh yêu cầu bảo hành
- **recover the cost** — thu hồi chi phí
- **stronger customer loyalty** — lòng trung thành khách hàng mạnh hơn
- **a selling point instead of a rarity** — điểm bán hàng thay vì hiếm có

#456 Agree / Disagree · 272 từ · AI 7.0

Many people think that DIY culture encourages sustainability. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Repairing a bicycle, making shelves from old planks or sewing a torn jacket was once ordinary, and today do-it-yourself, or DIY, activities are returning. I largely agree that DIY culture encourages sustainability, although its effect is limited without wider change.

To begin with, do-it-yourself culture encourages people to repair and reuse instead of throwing away. Fixing a broken item, making furniture from old materials or sharing tools extends the life of products, saves money and teaches useful skills. A neighbourhood repair cafe, for instance, lets residents mend toasters and bicycles together instead of buying replacements. Less waste is produced and fewer new goods have to be made, which saves energy and raw materials. People who have repaired something themselves also tend to value it more and are less likely to discard it casually. In this way, small personal habits can gradually shift what society regards as normal.

Furthermore, DIY activities change attitudes. When people see how things are built and how they fail, they start to question disposable products and demand items that can be repaired. Online videos, workshops and tool libraries make it easier than ever to learn. However, the effect of this culture is limited. Not everyone has the skills, tools or time to repair things, some repairs are unsafe, and the largest environmental impacts come from industry and transport rather than from households. DIY should therefore complement, not replace, wider changes such as durable design, the right to repair and cleaner production.

In conclusion, DIY culture encourages sustainability to a large extent by reducing waste and changing attitudes, but its effect is limited unless governments and companies also act.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **do-it-yourself** — tự làm lấy
- **DIY culture** — văn hoá tự làm
- **encourages sustainability** — khuyến khích sự bền vững
- **repair and reuse** — sửa chữa và tái sử dụng
- **instead of throwing away** — thay vì vứt đi
- **Fixing a broken item** — sửa món đồ hỏng
- **old materials** — vật liệu cũ
- **sharing tools** — dùng chung dụng cụ
- **extends the life of products** — kéo dài tuổi thọ sản phẩm
- **teaches useful skills** — dạy kỹ năng hữu ích
- **a neighbourhood repair cafe** — quán sửa chữa của khu phố
- **mend toasters and bicycles** — sửa máy nướng bánh và xe đạp
- **value it more** — trân trọng nó hơn
- **discard it casually** — vứt nó một cách tuỳ tiện
- **change attitudes** — thay đổi thái độ
- **question disposable products** — đặt câu hỏi về sản phẩm dùng một lần
- **tool libraries** — thư viện dụng cụ
- **the skills, tools or time** — kỹ năng, dụng cụ hoặc thời gian
- **some repairs are unsafe** — một số sửa chữa không an toàn
- **complement, not replace** — bổ sung chứ không thay thế
- **durable design** — thiết kế bền
- **the right to repair** — quyền được sửa chữa
- **cleaner production** — sản xuất sạch hơn

Advantages / Disadvantages

#77 Advantages / Disadvantages · 274 từ · AI 7.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on green technology? Use examples.

Green technology, such as electric vehicles, solar panels and energy-saving machines, is attracting a growing amount of investment. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on it: a cleaner environment with lower costs, and new industries and exports.

First and foremost, green technology improves the environment while saving money. Efficient buildings, appliances and factories use less energy, so they reduce both pollution and bills, and clean transport cuts the exhaust fumes that damage health in crowded cities. As a result, the country spends less on imported fuel and on treating illnesses caused by dirty air. A city that replaces diesel buses with electric ones, for example, enjoys quieter streets and cleaner air, and its transport company spends less on fuel in the long run.

In addition, green technology creates new industries and jobs. Companies that design batteries, smart meters or wind turbines employ engineers, factory workers and installers, and a country that develops expertise early can sell its products abroad. A country that becomes known for efficient batteries, for instance, can sell them to many others. Because other countries are also trying to reduce emissions, demand for these products is likely to keep growing. Early movers therefore gain experience that latecomers will find hard to match. Although the initial investment is high, the long-term returns in jobs, savings and exports are considerable, and they are likely to rise as the technology becomes cheaper and more widespread.

To sum up, green technology brings clear benefits to a country, above all a cleaner environment with lower costs and a stronger, more competitive economy. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Green technology** — công nghệ xanh
- **energy-saving machines** — máy móc tiết kiệm năng lượng
- **attracting a growing amount of investment** — thu hút ngày càng nhiều đầu tư
- **a cleaner environment with lower costs** — môi trường sạch hơn với chi phí thấp hơn
- **new industries and exports** — ngành mới và xuất khẩu
- **improves the environment while saving money** — cải thiện môi trường mà vẫn tiết kiệm tiền
- **Efficient buildings, appliances and factories** — toà nhà, thiết bị và nhà máy hiệu quả
- **reduce both pollution and bills** — giảm cả ô nhiễm lẫn hoá đơn
- **cuts the exhaust fumes** — cắt giảm khói thải
- **damage health** — gây hại sức khoẻ
- **spends less on imported fuel** — chi ít hơn cho nhiên liệu nhập khẩu
- **illnesses caused by dirty air** — bệnh do không khí bẩn
- **quieter streets** — đường phố yên tĩnh hơn
- **in the long run** — về lâu dài
- **smart meters** — công tơ thông minh
- **employ engineers, factory workers and installers** — thuê kỹ sư, công nhân nhà máy và thợ lắp đặt
- **sell its products abroad** — bán sản phẩm ra nước ngoài
- **keep growing** — tiếp tục tăng
- **the initial investment is high** — vốn đầu tư ban đầu cao
- **long-term returns** — lợi nhuận dài hạn
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#108 Advantages / Disadvantages · 268 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of nuclear energy.

Nuclear power supplies a significant share of electricity in several countries, yet it remains controversial. This essay will discuss the main advantages and disadvantages before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, nuclear plants produce large amounts of low-carbon electricity. A single plant can run day and night whatever the weather, so it provides steady power that wind and solar cannot always guarantee, and it releases almost no greenhouse gases while operating. Because a small amount of fuel produces a great deal of energy, countries can also reduce their dependence on imported coal and gas. A country with several reactors, for example, can keep its lights on during a calm, cloudy week without burning fossil fuels. Plants also last for sixty years or more, which gives a long period of stable production.

On the negative side, nuclear power carries serious risks and costs. Accidents are rare, but the consequences of a nuclear accident can be severe and long-lasting, as the disasters at Chernobyl and Fukushima showed. Radioactive waste must also be stored safely for thousands of years, which places a burden on future generations. In addition, plants are very expensive and often take over a decade to build, so they may be completed late and over budget. Safe operation requires strict regulation and highly trained staff, which poorer countries may find difficult to provide.

In conclusion, nuclear energy offers reliable low-carbon power, but its dangers, waste and cost are serious drawbacks. On balance, I believe that it should be one part of a mixed energy supply in countries with strong safety systems, rather than the main solution.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **supplies a significant share of electricity** — cung cấp tỷ trọng điện đáng kể
- **low-carbon electricity** — điện ít carbon
- **run day and night whatever the weather** — chạy ngày đêm bất kể thời tiết
- **steady power** — nguồn điện ổn định
- **cannot always guarantee** — không phải lúc nào cũng đảm bảo được
- **while operating** — khi vận hành
- **a small amount of fuel produces a great deal of energy** — một lượng nhỏ nhiên liệu tạo ra rất nhiều năng lượng
- **reduce their dependence on imported coal and gas** — giảm phụ thuộc vào than và khí nhập khẩu
- **keep its lights on** — giữ cho đèn vẫn sáng
- **a long period of stable production** — thời gian sản xuất ổn định dài
- **serious risks and costs** — rủi ro và chi phí nghiêm trọng
- **severe and long-lasting** — nghiêm trọng và kéo dài
- **Radioactive waste** — chất thải phóng xạ
- **a burden on future generations** — gánh nặng cho thế hệ sau
- **over budget** — vượt ngân sách
- **strict regulation** — quy định nghiêm ngặt
- **highly trained staff** — nhân viên được đào tạo bài bản
- **serious drawbacks** — nhược điểm nghiêm trọng
- **a mixed energy supply** — cơ cấu năng lượng hỗn hợp
- **strong safety systems** — hệ thống an toàn mạnh

#148 Advantages / Disadvantages · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of genetically modified crops.

Genetically modified crops, whose genes have been altered in a laboratory to give them useful traits, are widely grown in some countries and banned in others. This essay will discuss the main advantages and disadvantages before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, genetically modified crops can produce higher and more reliable yields. Plants can be changed to resist pests, tolerate drought or contain extra vitamins, so farmers lose less of their harvest and need fewer chemicals. More food is then grown on the same land, which helps a growing population. A farmer who plants a drought-resistant variety, for example, may still harvest a reasonable crop in a dry year, when ordinary seed would fail. Crops improved in this way can also reduce hunger and malnutrition in poorer regions.

On the negative side, however, the long-term effects of genetically modified crops are not fully known. Modified genes could spread to wild plants, and farmers who buy patented seed each year become dependent on a few large companies. Many consumers distrust modified food, and people in some countries worry about its safety even though the evidence so far is limited. Nevertheless, these concerns can be addressed. Careful testing, independent regulation and clear labels would allow consumers to make their own choices and would help to detect problems early. Public trust is essential, because even a safe product will fail if people refuse to buy it.

In conclusion, genetically modified crops offer real benefits for food supply, but uncertainty about long-term effects and corporate control are valid concerns. On balance, I believe that they should be used cautiously, under strict testing and open information.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Genetically modified crops** — cây trồng biến đổi gen
- **altered in a laboratory** — được thay đổi trong phòng thí nghiệm
- **useful traits** — đặc tính có ích
- **higher and more reliable yields** — năng suất cao và ổn định hơn
- **resist pests** — kháng sâu bệnh
- **tolerate drought** — chịu hạn
- **extra vitamins** — vitamin bổ sung
- **lose less of their harvest** — mất ít vụ mùa hơn
- **a growing population** — dân số ngày càng tăng
- **a drought-resistant variety** — giống chịu hạn
- **ordinary seed would fail** — hạt giống thường sẽ thất bại
- **hunger and malnutrition** — đói và suy dinh dưỡng
- **not fully known** — chưa được biết đầy đủ
- **spread to wild plants** — lan sang cây dại
- **patented seed** — hạt giống có bản quyền
- **dependent on a few large companies** — phụ thuộc vào vài công ty lớn
- **distrust modified food** — không tin thực phẩm biến đổi gen
- **Careful testing, independent regulation** — kiểm nghiệm cẩn thận, quản lý độc lập
- **detect problems early** — phát hiện vấn đề sớm
- **used cautiously** — được sử dụng thận trọng

#197 Advantages / Disadvantages · 276 từ · AI 8.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on renewable resources? Use examples.

Many countries are shifting from coal, oil and gas towards solar, wind and water power. This essay will outline two principal benefits of focusing on renewable resources: a cleaner and healthier environment, and greater energy security and economic opportunity.

First and foremost, renewable energy improves the environment and public health. Solar panels and wind turbines produce electricity without burning fuel, so they release almost no greenhouse gases and none of the smoke that harms people's lungs in crowded cities. As a result, the air is cleaner, hospitals treat fewer patients with breathing problems, and the country contributes to the effort to slow climate change. Denmark, for example, generates a large share of its electricity from wind, which shows that a small country can reduce its reliance on fossil fuels. A city that replaces a coal power station with wind and solar farms may notice clearer skies within a few years.

In addition, renewable resources make a country more secure and more prosperous. Nations that buy oil and gas from abroad are exposed to sudden price rises and political disputes, whereas home-grown wind and solar power gives them a stable and secure supply. The sector also creates employment in manufacturing, installation and maintenance, and countries that develop expertise early can sell equipment and skills to others. Because the sun and wind will not run out, these benefits last for future generations. Although renewable power needs storage and flexible grids, these costs are falling as technology improves.

To sum up, focusing on renewable resources brings clear benefits to a country, above all a cleaner environment and a more secure economy. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **shifting from coal, oil and gas** — chuyển từ than, dầu, khí
- **renewable resources** — tài nguyên tái tạo
- **a cleaner and healthier environment** — môi trường sạch và lành mạnh hơn
- **greater energy security** — an ninh năng lượng cao hơn
- **economic opportunity** — cơ hội kinh tế
- **improves the environment and public health** — cải thiện môi trường và sức khoẻ cộng đồng
- **without burning fuel** — không đốt nhiên liệu
- **release almost no greenhouse gases** — thải gần như không khí nhà kính
- **harms people's lungs** — gây hại phổi người
- **breathing problems** — vấn đề hô hấp
- **contributes to the effort to slow climate change** — góp phần làm chậm biến đổi khí hậu
- **generates a large share of its electricity from wind** — tạo ra phần lớn điện từ gió
- **reduce its reliance on fossil fuels** — giảm phụ thuộc vào nhiên liệu hoá thạch
- **clearer skies** — bầu trời trong hơn
- **more secure and more prosperous** — an toàn và thịnh vượng hơn
- **exposed to sudden price rises** — chịu ảnh hưởng của việc giá tăng đột ngột
- **political disputes** — tranh chấp chính trị
- **home-grown wind and solar power** — điện gió và mặt trời sản xuất trong nước
- **creates employment** — tạo việc làm
- **installation and maintenance** — lắp đặt và bảo trì
- **develop expertise early** — phát triển chuyên môn sớm
- **sell equipment and skills to others** — bán thiết bị và kỹ năng cho nước khác
- **will not run out** — sẽ không cạn kiệt
- **last for future generations** — kéo dài cho các thế hệ sau
- **storage and flexible grids** — lưu trữ và lưới điện linh hoạt
- **costs are falling** — chi phí đang giảm
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **a more secure economy** — nền kinh tế an toàn hơn
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#217 Advantages / Disadvantages · 280 từ · AI 8.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on renewable transport? Use examples.

Cars, buses and lorries that run on petrol and diesel are a major source of pollution. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on renewable transport, such as electric vehicles, trains and bicycles: cleaner air and better health, and lower dependence on imported fuel.

First and foremost, renewable transport improves air quality and public health. Electric buses and cars produce no exhaust fumes on the road, and when their power comes from wind or solar they release far fewer greenhouse gases over their lifetime. As a result, residents of crowded cities breathe cleaner air, noise levels fall and fewer people suffer from breathing problems. A city that replaces diesel buses with electric ones, for example, enjoys quieter streets and cleaner air, and its centre becomes a more pleasant place to walk, shop and live.

In addition, renewable transport makes a country more secure and more economical. Nations that buy oil from abroad are exposed to sudden price rises and political disputes, whereas home-grown electricity gives them a more stable supply. Electric vehicles also cost less to run, because electricity is usually cheaper than fuel per kilometre and they need less maintenance. The country can create jobs in building charging points, public transport and cycle routes, and manufacturers that lead in electric vehicles can sell them abroad. Although charging networks and cleaner power grids require large investment, the long-term savings are considerable. Cities that start early can also plan their streets around people instead of cars.

To sum up, renewable transport brings clear benefits to a country, above all cleaner air and a more secure, lower-cost transport system. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **run on petrol and diesel** — chạy bằng xăng và dầu diesel
- **a major source of pollution** — nguồn ô nhiễm chính
- **renewable transport** — giao thông tái tạo
- **electric vehicles, trains and bicycles** — xe điện, tàu hỏa và xe đạp
- **cleaner air and better health** — không khí sạch hơn và sức khoẻ tốt hơn
- **lower dependence on imported fuel** — ít phụ thuộc nhiên liệu nhập khẩu
- **improves air quality and public health** — cải thiện chất lượng không khí và sức khoẻ cộng đồng
- **produce no exhaust fumes on the road** — không thải khói trên đường
- **far fewer greenhouse gases over their lifetime** — ít khí nhà kính hơn nhiều trong suốt vòng đời
- **breathe cleaner air** — hít thở không khí sạch hơn
- **noise levels fall** — mức ồn giảm
- **suffer from breathing problems** — bị các vấn đề hô hấp
- **quieter streets** — đường phố yên tĩnh hơn
- **a more pleasant place to walk, shop and live** — nơi dễ chịu hơn để đi bộ, mua sắm và sống
- **more secure and more economical** — an toàn và tiết kiệm hơn
- **exposed to sudden price rises** — chịu ảnh hưởng của việc giá tăng đột ngột
- **political disputes** — tranh chấp chính trị
- **a more stable supply** — nguồn cung ổn định hơn
- **cost less to run** — chi phí vận hành thấp hơn
- **cheaper than fuel per kilometre** — rẻ hơn nhiên liệu trên mỗi km
- **need less maintenance** — cần ít bảo trì hơn
- **charging points** — trạm sạc
- **cycle routes** — đường dành cho xe đạp
- **sell them abroad** — bán ra nước ngoài
- **the long-term savings** — khoản tiết kiệm dài hạn
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#257 Advantages / Disadvantages · 276 từ · AI 8.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on agricultural innovation? Use examples.

Farming has changed more in the last few decades than in the previous thousand years, thanks to new machines, seeds and software. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on agricultural innovation: higher output with fewer resources, and stronger rural communities.

First and foremost, agricultural innovation allows farmers to produce more with fewer resources. Drip irrigation, sensors and better seeds deliver water and fertiliser exactly where plants need them, so yields rise while waste falls. A farm that switches from flooding its fields to drip irrigation, for example, can grow the same crop with far less water, which matters in dry regions. As a result, the country can feed its growing population without clearing more forest or farmland, and it saves money on chemicals and fuel. Drones and satellite images also help farmers to spot disease early and treat only the affected area.

In addition, innovation strengthens rural economies. Higher output and lower costs raise farm incomes, and new technology creates skilled jobs in areas such as equipment maintenance, data analysis and food processing. Young people who might otherwise leave for cities can find attractive careers in the countryside, which keeps villages alive. A country that develops advanced farming methods can also sell its equipment and expertise to others. Although new technology may be expensive for small farmers, shared equipment and training schemes can spread the benefits widely. Over time, wider use also lowers the cost of the equipment.

To sum up, agricultural innovation brings clear benefits to a country, above all greater and more efficient food production and a more prosperous countryside. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **changed more in the last few decades** — thay đổi nhiều hơn trong vài thập kỷ qua
- **new machines, seeds and software** — máy móc, hạt giống và phần mềm mới
- **agricultural innovation** — đổi mới nông nghiệp
- **higher output with fewer resources** — sản lượng cao hơn với ít tài nguyên hơn
- **stronger rural communities** — cộng đồng nông thôn vững mạnh hơn
- **produce more with fewer resources** — sản xuất nhiều hơn với ít tài nguyên hơn
- **Drip irrigation** — tưới nhỏ giọt
- **exactly where plants need them** — đúng nơi cây cần
- **yields rise while waste falls** — năng suất tăng trong khi lãng phí giảm
- **flooding its fields** — tưới tràn ruộng
- **dry regions** — vùng khô hạn
- **clearing more forest or farmland** — phá thêm rừng hoặc đất canh tác
- **spot disease early** — phát hiện bệnh sớm
- **treat only the affected area** — chỉ xử lý khu vực bị ảnh hưởng
- **raise farm incomes** — tăng thu nhập nông trại
- **skilled jobs** — việc làm có kỹ năng
- **data analysis and food processing** — phân tích dữ liệu và chế biến thực phẩm
- **keeps villages alive** — giữ cho làng quê sống động
- **sell its equipment and expertise** — bán thiết bị và chuyên môn
- **shared equipment and training schemes** — chương trình dùng chung thiết bị và đào tạo
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#295 Advantages / Disadvantages · 277 từ · AI 7.5

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on agriculture? Use examples.

Agriculture is often seen as an old-fashioned sector, yet it remains the foundation of every economy. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on agriculture: food security and a stable rural economy.

First and foremost, a strong farming sector protects a country's food security. A country that grows its own food depends less on imports and is less exposed to sudden price rises or supply problems on the world market. Reliable harvests also keep food affordable for ordinary families, which reduces hunger and protects public health. Countries that support their farmers during bad years, for example, can avoid shortages and keep prices stable. A nation that relies heavily on imported grain, in contrast, can find itself in difficulty when exporters restrict sales.

In addition, agriculture supports employment and rural stability. Farming, food processing, transport and equipment sales provide jobs and income for millions of people, particularly in areas with few other industries. This helps rural communities to remain viable, so that fewer people move to crowded cities in search of work, which in turn eases pressure on housing and services. Agricultural exports also earn foreign currency that can pay for imports of machinery and medicine. Because food is always in demand, the sector is relatively stable even when other industries face difficulties. Although farming depends on weather and is vulnerable to climate change, modern methods and insurance can reduce the risks. Governments can support this by investing in rural roads, storage and markets.

To sum up, focusing on agriculture brings clear benefits to a country, above all food security and a stable rural economy. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **old-fashioned sector** — ngành lỗi thời
- **the foundation of every economy** — nền tảng của mọi nền kinh tế
- **food security** — an ninh lương thực
- **a stable rural economy** — kinh tế nông thôn ổn định
- **depends less on imports** — ít phụ thuộc nhập khẩu
- **exposed to sudden price rises** — chịu ảnh hưởng của việc giá tăng đột ngột
- **supply problems on the world market** — vấn đề cung ứng trên thị trường thế giới
- **Reliable harvests** — vụ mùa ổn định
- **keep food affordable** — giữ thực phẩm vừa túi tiền
- **reduces hunger** — giảm nạn đói
- **support their farmers** — hỗ trợ nông dân
- **avoid shortages** — tránh thiếu hụt
- **restrict sales** — hạn chế bán hàng
- **employment and rural stability** — việc làm và sự ổn định ở nông thôn
- **remain viable** — vẫn tồn tại được
- **in search of work** — tìm việc làm
- **earn foreign currency** — kiếm ngoại tệ
- **always in demand** — luôn có nhu cầu
- **vulnerable to climate change** — dễ bị tổn thương bởi biến đổi khí hậu
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#321 Advantages / Disadvantages · 276 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of nuclear power outweigh the environmental risks? Give reasons and examples.

Concerns about climate change have revived interest in nuclear power, but it also raises environmental questions. This essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages before explaining whether the advantages outweigh the risks.

On the positive side, nuclear power helps to reduce the environmental harm caused by fossil fuels. A reactor produces large amounts of electricity without releasing the greenhouse gases or the smoke that harms people's lungs, and it needs far less land than solar or wind farms to generate the same output. Replacing coal stations with nuclear plants can therefore cut carbon emissions and improve air quality at the same time. A city that closes a coal plant and opens a nuclear one, for example, may see a clear fall in air pollution within a few years.

On the negative side, nuclear power carries environmental risks of its own. Mining uranium damages land, and radioactive waste has to be stored safely for thousands of years. Plants also use large amounts of water for cooling, which can warm rivers and harm fish, and a serious accident would contaminate air, soil and water over a wide area. Nevertheless, these risks can be managed. Modern waste is small in volume and can be sealed deep underground, and strict regulation has made serious accidents extremely rare. In comparison, the damage from fossil fuels is certain, continuous and global, and it falls on every country. For this reason, even a technology with real risks may be the lesser evil when the alternative is continued dependence on coal.

In conclusion, the advantages of nuclear power outweigh its environmental risks, provided that governments invest in secure waste storage and independent safety checks.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **revived interest in nuclear power** — làm sống lại mối quan tâm đến điện hạt nhân
- **raises environmental questions** — đặt ra câu hỏi về môi trường
- **outweigh the risks** — lớn hơn rủi ro
- **the environmental harm caused by fossil fuels** — tác hại môi trường do nhiên liệu hoá thạch
- **harms people's lungs** — gây hại phổi người
- **needs far less land than solar or wind farms** — cần ít đất hơn nhiều so với điện mặt trời hay gió
- **generate the same output** — tạo cùng sản lượng
- **improve air quality** — cải thiện chất lượng không khí
- **at the same time** — đồng thời
- **a clear fall in air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí giảm rõ rệt
- **environmental risks of its own** — rủi ro môi trường riêng
- **Mining uranium damages land** — khai thác uranium làm hại đất
- **Radioactive waste** — chất thải phóng xạ
- **warm rivers and harm fish** — làm ấm sông và hại cá
- **contaminate air, soil and water** — làm nhiễm bẩn không khí, đất và nước
- **over a wide area** — trên diện rộng
- **can be managed** — có thể kiểm soát
- **small in volume** — thể tích nhỏ
- **sealed deep underground** — niêm phong sâu dưới lòng đất
- **strict regulation** — quy định nghiêm ngặt
- **certain, continuous and global** — chắc chắn, liên tục và toàn cầu
- **secure waste storage** — kho chứa chất thải an toàn
- **independent safety checks** — kiểm tra an toàn độc lập

#350 Advantages / Disadvantages · 287 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of pesticide use in agriculture.

Pesticides, which are chemicals used to kill insects, weeds and fungi, are applied to crops in almost every farming region. This essay will discuss the main advantages and disadvantages before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, pesticides protect crops from insects, weeds and disease. Without them farmers could lose a large share of their harvest, which would raise food prices and leave more people hungry. They also allow fruit and vegetables to look attractive and to last longer in shops, so less food is thrown away. A grower whose orchard is hit by a destructive insect, for example, may lose most of the fruit within weeks unless the pest is controlled. For many families, cheaper and more reliable food is a real benefit.

On the negative side, however, pesticides can harm people, wildlife and water. Residues may stay on food, chemicals wash into rivers and kill useful insects such as bees, and pests gradually become resistant, which forces farmers to use stronger products. Farm workers who handle these chemicals without protection may also suffer from illness. Nevertheless, the harm can be reduced. Integrated pest management, which combines natural predators, crop rotation and small amounts of spraying only when needed, protects harvests while using far fewer chemicals. Strict rules on which products are allowed and on safe use would also help. Farmers who are trained to spray carefully, at the right time and in the right amount, can protect their crops while limiting the damage to nearby streams.

In conclusion, pesticides play an important role in feeding the world, but their effects on health and the environment are serious. On balance, I believe that they should be used sparingly and under strict control, alongside safer methods.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Pesticides** — thuốc trừ sâu
- **kill insects, weeds and fungi** — diệt côn trùng, cỏ dại và nấm
- **applied to crops** — được phun lên cây trồng
- **protect crops from insects, weeds and disease** — bảo vệ cây trồng khỏi côn trùng, cỏ dại và bệnh
- **a large share of their harvest** — phần lớn vụ mùa
- **raise food prices** — làm tăng giá thực phẩm
- **leave more people hungry** — khiến nhiều người đói hơn
- **last longer in shops** — để được lâu hơn trong cửa hàng
- **thrown away** — bị vứt đi
- **a destructive insect** — loài côn trùng phá hoại
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát
- **cheaper and more reliable food** — thực phẩm rẻ và ổn định hơn
- **harm people, wildlife and water** — gây hại người, động vật hoang dã và nước
- **Residues** — dư lượng
- **wash into rivers** — trôi xuống sông
- **useful insects such as bees** — côn trùng có ích như ong
- **become resistant** — trở nên kháng thuốc
- **handle these chemicals without protection** — dùng hoá chất mà không bảo hộ
- **Integrated pest management** — quản lý dịch hại tổng hợp
- **natural predators, crop rotation** — thiên địch, luân canh
- **sparingly and under strict control** — hạn chế và kiểm soát chặt

#370 Advantages / Disadvantages · 275 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of biofuels.

Biofuels, which are made from crops, waste and other plant material, are increasingly mixed with petrol and diesel. This essay will discuss their main advantages and disadvantages before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, biofuels can reduce the carbon emissions of transport. Plants absorb carbon dioxide as they grow, so in theory the fuel releases about the same amount that it removed from the air, which makes it cleaner over its life than oil. It can also be used in existing engines and fuel stations with little change, so countries do not have to replace all their vehicles at once. In addition, growing fuel crops supports farmers and reduces dependence on imported oil. A country that blends plant-based fuel into its petrol, for example, can cut emissions from millions of cars quickly, long before electric vehicles become common.

On the negative side, biofuels raise serious concerns about land and food. Fuel crops need farmland, so they may compete with food production and push up prices, which hurts poorer families most. If forests are cleared to plant them, the carbon released can cancel out the benefits. Growing, fertilising and processing crops also consumes energy and water. Biofuels made from waste, such as used cooking oil, avoid many of these problems, but supplies are limited. Research into fuels from algae and farm residues may widen the supply in future.

In conclusion, biofuels offer a useful way to cut transport emissions, but their effect on land and food prices is a real drawback. On balance, I believe that they should be developed mainly from waste materials, while other options such as electric vehicles receive greater support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Biofuels** — nhiên liệu sinh học
- **made from crops, waste and other plant material** — làm từ cây trồng, chất thải và vật liệu thực vật khác
- **mixed with petrol and diesel** — pha vào xăng và dầu diesel
- **reduce the carbon emissions of transport** — giảm khí thải carbon của giao thông
- **absorb carbon dioxide as they grow** — hấp thụ CO2 khi lớn lên
- **in theory** — về lý thuyết
- **cleaner over its life than oil** — sạch hơn dầu trong suốt vòng đời
- **existing engines and fuel stations** — động cơ và trạm xăng hiện có
- **with little change** — ít phải thay đổi
- **replace all their vehicles at once** — thay hết xe cùng lúc
- **supports farmers** — hỗ trợ nông dân
- **blends plant-based fuel into its petrol** — pha nhiên liệu từ thực vật vào xăng
- **serious concerns about land and food** — mối lo ngại nghiêm trọng về đất và lương thực
- **compete with food production** — cạnh tranh với sản xuất lương thực
- **push up prices** — đẩy giá lên
- **hurts poorer families most** — làm hại gia đình nghèo nhất
- **cancel out the benefits** — triệt tiêu lợi ích
- **fertilising and processing crops** — bón phân và chế biến cây trồng
- **used cooking oil** — dầu ăn đã qua sử dụng
- **supplies are limited** — nguồn cung có hạn
- **Residues** — dư lượng
- **transport emissions** — khí thải từ vận chuyển

#399 Advantages / Disadvantages · 277 từ · AI 7.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on clean water access? Use examples.

Hundreds of millions of people still lack a safe and reliable water supply. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on clean water access: better health and wider opportunities for education and work.

First and foremost, clean water protects health. Safe drinking water prevents diseases such as diarrhoea and cholera, which kill many young children, and proper sanitation stops infections from spreading. As a result, fewer people become ill, hospitals are less crowded and families spend less on medicine. A village that gains a safe tap, for example, sees fewer children miss school because of stomach illness, and healthier adults are able to work more regularly. In the long term, a healthy population is also cheaper for the country to support.

In addition, clean water frees time for education and work. Where there is no tap nearby, women and girls often spend several hours every day carrying water, which stops them from attending school or earning money. Piped water removes this burden, so more girls can complete their education and more adults can take paid jobs. Reliable water also supports farming, food processing and manufacturing, which raises productivity and attracts investment. Healthier, better-educated people make the economy stronger, and the benefits continue across generations. Clean water is therefore an investment in people rather than simply a public service. Although building pipes and treatment plants requires large investment, studies in many countries suggest that the returns in health and productivity are far greater than the cost.

To sum up, clean water access brings clear benefits to a country, above all better health and wider opportunities. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Hundreds of millions of people** — hàng trăm triệu người
- **a safe and reliable water supply** — nguồn cấp nước an toàn và ổn định
- **clean water access** — tiếp cận nước sạch
- **better health** — sức khoẻ tốt hơn
- **wider opportunities for education and work** — cơ hội học tập và việc làm rộng hơn
- **Safe drinking water** — nước uống an toàn
- **prevents diseases such as diarrhoea and cholera** — ngăn các bệnh như tiêu chảy và dịch tả
- **proper sanitation** — vệ sinh đúng cách
- **stops infections from spreading** — ngăn nhiễm trùng lây lan
- **hospitals are less crowded** — bệnh viện bớt đông
- **spend less on medicine** — chi ít hơn cho thuốc
- **a safe tap** — vòi nước an toàn
- **miss school** — nghỉ học
- **healthier adults** — người lớn khoẻ mạnh hơn
- **carrying water** — gánh nước
- **Piped water** — nước máy dẫn bằng ống
- **take paid jobs** — nhận việc có lương
- **raises productivity and attracts investment** — tăng năng suất và thu hút đầu tư
- **across generations** — qua nhiều thế hệ
- **the returns in health and productivity** — lợi ích về sức khoẻ và năng suất
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài